



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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OF GHANA

SECOND MEETING, 2025

Monday, 21st July, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber of
Parliament at 2.46 p.m.*

[HON SECOND DEPUTY
SPEAKER, MR ANDREW
ASIAMAH AMOAKO IN THE
CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

[NATIONAL PLEDGE]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us turn to the item numbered 6 on today's Order Paper, *Correction of Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Reports*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS
AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let us begin with the *Votes and Proceedings*. We have, before us, *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday 18th July, 2025.

Page 1...12—

Yes, Hon Member for Afadjato South?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I am grateful for the opportunity. This is just a minor observation on page 12, item 10 (i), under the sub-heading “Statements” where the respected Hon Member for Salaga South has been captured here as Salaga. I think that we have Salaga South and North.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Table, please acknowledge that correction.

Page 13...15—

Yes, Hon Member for Afadjato South?

Mr Afriyie: Thank you, Mr Speaker. Once again, on the supplementary page, under the Joint Committee on Education and Public Administration and State Interests, on the last line of the second paragraph under “opening”, I think we should insert the name of the Chairman after “State Interests”.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Are you a member of the Committee?

Mr Afriyie: No, Mr Speaker, sorry, not to litigate, but if I could throw more light, permit me to read. “The Hon Member for Akatsi North and Chairman of the Committee on Education, Mr Peter Kwasi Nortsu-Kotoe, and the Hon Member for Asante Akim South and Chairman of the Committee on Public Administration and State Interests...”

I am of the opinion that his name should be inserted.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Thank you very much. So, Table, kindly acknowledge that.

Hon Member for Afadjato South, once again, I commend you for your diligence. Thank you very much.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I am grateful.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, page 16 – 17?

Hon Members, in the absence of any further questions, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 18th July, 2025, as corrected is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, I have in my hands the *Official Report* of Monday, 14th July, 2025.

2.56 p.m.

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Monday, 14th July, 2025]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Leadership?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we have some Statements to be taken, that is the item numbered 7. Before then, may I pray, that we vary the order of Business, so that we take some Papers that are ready under the item numbered 8.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the respected Majority Chief Whip has just mounted an application for us to vary the order of Business. There should be no problem with that, but I want to bring this to his notice. On Friday, when the Business Statement was presented by the Leader of the House, I brought this matter up, about concerns that are still lingering.

Mr Speaker, you had counselled that we should not elucidate on these matters. So, without saying more, I invite you to, with respect, direct that tomorrow we should have a Committee of the Whole. As we are all aware—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: On what?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, Committee of the Whole on matters of importance. Hon Members are distressed on both Sides. The Minister for Finance had promised to be here, yet, he still has not shown any sign. Mr Speaker, we have to meet him tomorrow in order to get the House ready to receive him on Thursday. I am sure Colleagues agree with me.

Mr Speaker, I have checked the mood of the House, and Hon Members are distressed. So, may I invite you to direct that the Minister for Finance be here. He must not fail

tomorrow. If he cannot make it, his Deputy should come. Thankfully, they are our Colleagues; they are all Members of Parliament. Tomorrow, they must be in this House; whether rain or shine, they must be here.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Majority Leadership, the application has been made to me.

Who said “It is right?” *[Laughter]*

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, he did not speak for the record.

Mr Speaker, I understand the language my Brother on the other Side of the Volta Lake is speaking. I agree with him. So, instead of the Committee of the Whole, we will have a Closed Sitting to consider—These are pertinent welfare issues, so I agree with him. I would not litigate these matters with him at all. I would endeavour to reach out to the Minister for Finance and his Deputy as soon as possible, and of course, my Leader, who is also engaged in some other work up North as we speak. We will indicate how, with alacrity, the Minister for Finance can come and deal with these matters because of what we will be doing on Thursday. These are the protocols we must go through. So, I agree with him.

Mr Speaker, but he has not given the indications that he has no objection to my application. So, once he has no objection to the application—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Is it Closed Sitting?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, Closed Sitting.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Not Committee of the Whole?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, we would have a Closed Sitting.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, whether Closed Sitting or Committee of the Whole, there must be a Sitting. The Sitting must be honoured by the Minister for Finance.

Mr Speaker, without adding more, I support his application. Except that, he said he will endeavour to bring the Minister for Finance. He should not endeavour. He is being whipped to go and bring the Minister for Finance.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I think he said that.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, no, he did not say that. He said he will endeavour. That is not enough. As the Majority Chief Whip, he must bring the Minister for Finance. He should confirm that he would bring the Minister for Finance. He has powers. Hon Majority Chief Whip, do something.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, seven months ago, my Brother was in this seat, and I saw how difficult it

was to get Mr Ken Ofori-Atta to come here. That is why I am being careful and saying I will endeavour. It is not the 187 Members that would bring the Minister for Finance, but whatever it is, I want to assure him and the House that, we will endeavour to let the Minister for Finance come to deal with the issues that are germane to a very conducive atmosphere for Thursday. That is what we are all looking for. We are committed to doing that.

Mr Speaker, without much ado, may we—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: But I have not spoken.

Hon Members, I believe the application is well placed. So, we will direct that the Minister for Finance should be here tomorrow for a Closed Sitting with Hon Members to discuss matters of mutual importance.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, he gave some latitude. So, the Minister for Finance or his Deputy should be able to come to address the issues.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. I believe he is not available, and he will obviously ask his Deputy to come.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, his Deputy can be motivated to come to deal with these issues.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. I so direct.

Let me now call on the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs.

I hope you have made an application to vary the order of Business?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, Mr Speaker. It was that application that gave birth to my Brother making further applications to the House.

Mr Speaker, we will want to take the items numbered 8(c), (d), (e), (f), and (g) sequentially. In making this application, I have the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Which one are you doing first?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we are taking the item numbered 8(c) by the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources. The Minister is unavoidably absent. So, I pray that the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs takes this on behalf of the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources for us. I so move.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I cannot oppose my good Friend laying the Paper. The Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources has a dependable Deputy. He has a Deputy who is a Member of Parliament. Well, so — *[Interruption]*—No, I will support him, but he should wait. The Minister is not here, and the Deputy is also not

here. All right. There is no problem. He may proceed.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well, Hon Members, the application—

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, these are important matters. If we may recall, the President commissioned the phase two of the Keta Sea Defence project over the weekend. As I speak, the Minister and his Deputy are back at the project site with some consultants who are supposed to — *[Interruption]*—

3.06 p.m.

I spoke to them this morning and they are there with a consultant and some directors, so that the project can take off with alacrity. Mr Speaker, it is not by deliberate design for them to refuse to be here this morning.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Members, the application—

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Before he proceeds, there is no problem. He should not go into defence; he should just accept it. Because if it is the case that they are Blekusu—Yes, I read the news on the internet, so if they are still sojourning at Blekusu, that is fine. There is no problem, but they must prioritise the work of Parliament. At least, the Minister can be at Blekusu and the Deputy can rush to Parliament all in the spirit of resetting. The

Majority said they are resetting Ghana; how can both the Minister and the Deputy be at Blekusu at the same time? The Deputy Minister can come and lay the Papers and the Minister will be there.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I did not say they remained in Blekusu; they are back this morning with the consultant—*Eii! Annoh—Annoh*, you used to be here—*[Laughter]*—Mr Speaker let us make some progress.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the leave is granted and the Minister for Local Government—

Mr Ahmed Ibrahim: Mr Speaker, your Friend, the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs, is available and a Friend to Hon Minority Chief Whip as well.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, that is why nobody here is afraid.

Mr Ibrahim: Mr Speaker, *mennsuro. [Laughter]*

PAPERS

By the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs on behalf of the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources —

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Architectural and

Engineering Services Limited for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Works and Housing.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may we take the item numbered 8(d), standing in the name of the Minister of State, Government Communications.

Mr Speaker, I stand on my earlier submissions to pray that the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs takes that one as well.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: The leave is granted.

Mr Dafeamekpor: No, he is not at Blekusu.

By the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs on behalf of the by the Minister of State in Charge of Government Communication —

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the State Interest and Governance Authority for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Public Administration and State Interests.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I pray that we take item numbered 8(e), standing in the name of the Minister for Energy and Green

Transition. Mr Speaker, once more, may I pray that the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs does the honours and lay the Papers on behalf of the Minister for Energy and Green Transition.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, the leave is granted.

By the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs on behalf of the by the Minister for Energy and Green Transition —

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Grid Company Limited for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Energy.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I pray that item numbered 8 (f), standing in the name of the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs, be now taken. Mr Speaker, in doing so, I pray that the items numbered 8(f)(i) to (xxii) be taken.

By the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs —

(i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ga East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(ii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ashanti Regional Coordinating Council for the year 2024.

- (iii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Afigya Kwabre South District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (iv) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Afigya Kwabre North District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (v) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sefwi Akontombra District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (vi) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ablekuma North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (vii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Okere District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (viii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Shama District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (ix) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Amansie Central District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (x) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Amansie South District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (xi) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kwadaso Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (xii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Asunafo North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (xiii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Adansi North District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (xiv) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nkoranza North District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (xv) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Old Tafo Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (xvi) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Agona West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (xvii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tano South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (xviii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sekyere East District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (xix) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Lower Manya Krobo Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(xx) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Birim North District Assembly for the year 2024.

(xxi) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ayawaso East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(xxii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Keta Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Local Government and Rural Development

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I further pray that the item numbered 8(g) be taken. Mr Speaker, in doing so, the item numbered 8(g)(i) to (cxxxix) be taken and blocked because of the sheer number that is listed. So, if the *Hansard* can capture from the item numbered 8 (g) (i) to (cxxxix).

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I recall earlier that I related to my Colleague on the same subject matter and he had raised concerns about some errors. I do not know if these errors have been rectified already. If it is the case that it has been rectified, then I am sure we can proceed.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, there were cases of misnomer; that is misnaming of the Instruments. They have been corrected. Mr Speaker, on that note, I pray that they be taken.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Who is doing that on behalf of the Minister?

Mr Dafeamekpor: May I pray the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: No, he has done a lot. Probably, the Minister for Health can do that.

3.16 p.m.

Mr Dafeamekpor: All right.

We pray the Minister for Health to do this on our behalf.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, like the application made to me by the Majority Chief Whip, the Utilisation Contracts spans from page 4 all the way to page 24, so the Clerks-at-the-Table cannot read everything verbatim. So, I assume that everything has been read; the *Hansard* should capture it as if it has been read in full.

By the Minister for Health on behalf of the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources—

1. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Nasmo Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

2. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Adjokyesant Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.
3. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.
4. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve (Akim Portion) within the Begoro Forest District of the Eastern Region.
5. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Nyamebe Bepo Forest Reserve within the New Edubiase Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
6. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Pyonteak Ventures Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.
7. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Bia Tano Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
8. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Supremo Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Bia Tano Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
9. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.

10. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Supremo Woods Processing Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.
11. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Fab Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Ajueso Forest Reserve within the Assin Foso Forest District of the Central Region.
12. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Diago Construction Limited in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region.
13. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Subin Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
14. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Mr Bee Company Limited in respect of the Bowiye Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.
15. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Manukab Company Limited in respect of the Bonsa Ben Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.
16. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Fosuaa Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.
17. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

18. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Rakhishem Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.
19. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.
20. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.
21. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ayipa Wood Company Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
22. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Anthony Bosompem Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.
23. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and R. K. Preprah Company Limited in respect of the Dampia Range Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
24. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Francydus Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.
25. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and R. K. Preprah and Company Limited in respect of the Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the

Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

26. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.
27. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ayum Forest Products limited in respect of the Bonkoni Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
28. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Tano Suraw Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Bono Region.
29. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Bia Shelterbelt Forest

Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

30. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.
31. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex Timber and Plywood Limited in respect of the Tano Anwia Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.
32. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Fum Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
33. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry

of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

34. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Anhwiaso East Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Western North Region.

35. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Memorial Company Limited in respect of the Awisam Seidukrom Off Reserve within the Assin Foso Forest District of the Central Region.

36. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien Block II Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region.

37. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Oda River Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

38. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Waiwso Forest District of the Western North Region.

39. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex Timbers and Plywood Limited in respect of the Tano Nimri Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.

40. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Gimpex Limited in respect of the Supuma Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

41. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bonsa River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Central Region.
42. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Broadwater Company Limited in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve within the Mpraeso Forest District of the Easter Region.
43. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Elton and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve within the Assin Fosu Forest District of the Central Region.
44. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Kan Royal Timbers in respect of the Sui River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region.
45. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and R.K. Peprah Company Limited in respect of the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.
46. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve within the Assin Fosu Forest District of the Central Region.
47. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Kan Royal Timbers Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.
48. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Akwadiaso Company Limited in respect of the Bowiye Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

49. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Vesta Construction Works Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.
50. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Dampia Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
51. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Gimpex Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
52. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Lebadinni Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

53. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and John Bitar and Company Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.
54. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and GWP Ghana Limited in respect of the Fum Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
55. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Dangyimah and Sons Limited in respect of the Tano Offin Forest Reserve within the Nkawei Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
56. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Goodrich Packaging Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa

Forest District of the Bono Region.

57. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Santomang Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.
58. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Slyvent Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve within the Juaboso-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region.
59. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and New Abrabo Construction Limited in respect of the Jema Asemkrom Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.
60. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural

Resources) and Yusam Wood Processing Company Limited in respect of the Nueng South Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.

61. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and R.K. Preprah Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.
62. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Francydus Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.
63. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Coppon Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Birim Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region.
64. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural

Resources) and Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Totua Shelter-belt Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western North Region.

65. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Fure Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

66. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Bonsam Bepo Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

67. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and S.K. Owusu Timbers Limited in respect of the Worobong South Forest Reserve (Akim) within the Begoro Forest District of the Eastern Region.

68. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and A.O. Mainoo Timbers Limited in respect of the Nyamekyere Off-Reserve within the Nkawie Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

69. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmills Processing Limited in respect of the Akwadaakrom Off-Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

70. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Timber and Consultation Limited in respect of the Nsuensa Forest Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region.

71. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Mafia 'b' Off- Reserve within the Juabaso Forest District of the Western Region.

72. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Bosomkese Forest Reserve within the Bechem Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

73. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Anglogold Ashanti (Ghana) Limited in respect of the Oda River Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

74. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Bia North Tributaries Forest Reserve within the Juabeso Forest District of the Western Region.

75. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of

the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

76. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Bio Tano Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western Region.

77. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ayum Forest Products Limited in respect of the Ayum Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

78. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ghana Primewood Limited in respect of the Bowiye Range Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

79. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ayum Forest

Products Limited in respect of the Subim Forest Reserve within the Goaso Forest District of the Ahafo Region.

80. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Mafia 'C' OFF-Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.
81. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Suhum Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.
82. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Pas Timbers Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien BLK 1 Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region.
83. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex

Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Yoyo River Forest Reserve within the Enchi Forest District of the Western North Region.

84. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Boison Construction Limited in respect of the Tano Suraw Forest Reserve within the Bibiani Forest District of the Western North Region.
85. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.
86. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Timber and Consulting Limited in respect of the Pra Birim North Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region.
87. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in

respect of the Bura River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

88. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and JMO Timber and Sawmills Limited in respect of the Kokotintin Forest Reserve within the New Edubiase Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

89. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Coppon Wood Processing Company Limited in respect of the Pra Birim South Forest Reserve within the Oda Forest District of the Eastern Region.

90. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Memorial Company Limited in respect of the Assin Donkorkrom Off Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

91. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Adras

Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

92. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Supremo Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

93. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Berekum Wood Processing Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

94. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ayipah Wood Company Limited in respect of the Pra Suhien BLK II Forest Reserve within the Cape Coast Forest District of the Central Region.

95. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and AB Saab Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve

within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

96. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Adjiboat Company Limited in respect of the Opon Mansi Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.
97. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Evans Timbers Limited in respect of the Draw River Forest Reserve within the Tarkwa Forest District of the Western Region.
98. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and MF-Timart Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.
99. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Joaddai Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest

Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

100. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex Timber and Plywood Limited in respect of the Nhwini North/Nhwini Nyele Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.
101. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and J.M.O. Timbers Limited in respect of the Numia Forest Reserve within the New Edubiasi Forest District of the Ashanti Region.
102. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Versatile Ghana Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.
103. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of

the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Vesta Construction and Sawmill Company Limited in respect of the Mpameso Forest Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

104. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ibrahim and Sons Company Limited in respect of the Asukese Forest Reserve within the Sunyani Forest District of the Bono Region.

105. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Yiogo Lebadinni Company Limited in respect of the Bia Tributaries North Forest Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

106. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmill Limited in respect of the Nsereso Off Reverse within the Dormaa

Forest District of the Bono Region.

107. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Timber and Consulting Limited in respect of the Aiyalo Forest Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region.

108. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Western Industrial Farms and Company Limited in respect of the Ayamfori Off Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

109. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Dwira Bansa Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

110. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Asuo Bomosadu Timber and Sawmill Limited in respect

of the Benkasa Off Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

111. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Western Industrial Farms and Company Limited in respect of the Mamangso Off Reserve within the Kade Forest District of the Eastern Region.

112. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and J.M.O Timber Limited in respect of the Afia Shelterbelt Forest Reserve within the New Edubiasi Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

113. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Nana Ama Agyeiwaa Company Limited in respect of the Ayinabrim Off Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

114. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex

Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure River Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

115. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve 'A' within the Juabobo-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region.

116. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Ejura Timbers Company Limited in respect of the Numia Forest Reserve.

117. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Logs and Lumber Limited in respect of the Tonton Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

118. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural

Resources) and Logs Court Limited in respect of the Bimpong Forest Reserve.

119. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Fure Headwaters Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

120. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Asuo Bomosadu Timbers and Sawmills Limited in respect of the Diabaakrom Off Reserve within the Dormaa Forest District of the Bono Region.

121. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Wiawso Off Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

122. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry

of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Suhuma Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western North Region.

123. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Nkrabea Forest Reserve within the Bekwai Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

124. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and J.M.O Timbers Limited in respect of the Nyamebe Bepo Forest Reserve within the New Edubiasi Forest District of the Ashanti Region.

125. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Mamiri Forest Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

126. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry

of Lands and Natural Resources) and John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Fure River Forest Reserve within the Sefwi Wiawso Forest District of the Western Region.

127. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Logs & Lumber Limited in respect of the Trans Bia Off Reserve within the Juaboso Forest District of the Western North Region.

128. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Samartex Timber & Plywood Limited in respect of the Nhwini Suraw Off Reserve within the Asankragwa Forest District of the Western Region.

129. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and G.K.L. Timbers Company Limited in respect of the Bonsa Ben Forest Reserve within the Dunkwa Forest District of the Central Region.

130. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and John Bitar & Company Limited in respect of the Krokosua Hills Forest Reserve 'B' within the Juabobo-Bia Forest District of the Western North Region.

131. Timber Utilisation Contract between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Western Hardwood Limited in respect of the Subri Forest Reserve within the Takoradi Forest District of the Western Region.

Referred to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I pray that we take the item numbered 9 – Presentation and First Reading of Bills, particularly the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well, but before we get there, indulge me to acknowledge our children and guests at the Public Gallery who are here to visit and witness their representatives.

They are Eagle Nest Community School, led by Daniel Owiredi, the

Headteacher. The school is located in the Assin Central Constituency. I hope we have the Member of Parliament here—We do not have—

Mr Dafemakpor: Mr Speaker, the Member for Assin Central is a regular Member and active participant in this House. As we speak, there are Committee Meetings—*[Interruption]*—In fact, as we speak, the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources is meeting at the Justice D. F. Annan Auditorium considering the timber resources Instruments. Mr Speaker, they know, so, that information should not go into the records. The Hon Member is an active participant, so they are welcome. On his behalf, I welcome them.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

[Pupils of Eagle Nest Community School in Assin Central were acknowledged.]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: The second school is Bell's International School, led by Felix Danyagre, a teacher. The school is located in the Tema West Constituency. Do we have the Member here? Yes, Lawyer, your children are here. I hope you take very good care of them. Very well.

[Pupils of Bell's International School from Tema West were acknowledged.]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: The third school is Upwind Academy, led

by Vida Mintah who is the secretary, and the school is located in the Ashaiman Constituency. Do we have Ashaiman North Constituency? Well, it has been written as Ashaiman North; that is why I wanted to find out.

[Pupils of Upwind Academy in Ashaiman were acknowledged]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, you are all welcome. We wish you —

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the record should be corrected to reflect that it is Ashaiman Constituency, not Ashaiman North Constituency.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Table, take note of that.

So, our children, you are welcome. We wish you well. You should be motivated enough to study hard, so that tomorrow, you will take our place when we are no more here.

Mr Ahmed Ibrahim: Mr Speaker, as Members of Parliament, when the House started giving recognition to students and guests at the Public Gallery, the practice in the Eighth Parliament was to make sure that the Director of Public Engagement gives the itinerary of students or people who will be visiting the House each day to be put on platforms of the Caucuses, so that Members were made aware. When a Member has an engagement with either a Minister, at a Committee meeting or any other place, he will

then prioritise Plenary because Plenary is not the only work that we do and that is why it is necessary for the Director of Public Engagement to link up with the Whips and give them the names of schools that will be visiting the House each day. I hope that practice would be revisited.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I think that is a good advice.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Let me assure my senior Brother, who left this seat for us, that the Business Committee has considered this, so not only visitation of schools to the House but also, when Statements standing in the name of Members will be taken, it will also reflect in the Business Statement as well as on the Order Paper, and such other matters, so that Members will know. It is a very laudable idea that the Business Committee has already taken cognizance of, so I want to assure the House.

Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe: Mr Speaker, it would be good if the camera will zoom on Members who are in the Chamber and their students are here to allow them to even welcome their students, so that the students could feel their MP in the Chamber. As we are here, the camera did not zoom on the Member of Parliament for Ashaiman and Lawyer Enu and they were not given the opportunity to even wave at them in the camera. It is very important. Mr Speaker, and with Ashaiman, we have

a lot of “states”, so it is a “united states of Ashaiman”.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: United states of?

Ms Cudjoe: United states of Ashaiman; we have lots of states. We have New York and so many states there.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I think all the suggestions are welcome. It is important that if, for instance, a school from my constituency comes here, having driven all the way from Fomena to Parliament and at least, we do not have that synergy—Henceforth, we will take note of that.

3.26 p.m.

But like what the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs said, I think it is crucial. Even if we cannot do that for the schools that are coming, the Office of Public Engagement should be able to contact the Members of Parliament that their students will be here, so they can also make time to come and meet the students.

Very well, Hon Majority Chief Whip.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, earlier, I had applied for the item listed under the item numbered 9, Presentation of Papers and First Reading of Bills to be taken, particularly the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025.

Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister has been here since 6 a.m. In fact, since yesterday.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Health—We will not object, but I am surprised at the latter statement of the Whip, that the Minister has been here since yesterday. I do not know. Did we sit yesterday?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: But that is why I saw the Hon Member for Effiduase/Asokore and Ranking Member for Health going to sympathise with him for coming here yesterday.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, do not allow yourself to be taken away —[*Laughter*]. The Whip is misleading you. He should go ahead and do the needful.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, in pursuance of our Orders, sufficient copies ought to be prepared. The man came yesterday to prepare sufficient copies. These are the copies.

So, Mr Speaker, it is not late.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Chief Whip, where we are going is another thing. I do not even have the copy.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we have sufficient copies.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: He is going to create problems for himself. Can he allow the Minister to lay the Paper?

Mr Dafeamekpor: He is creating the problem for me. I only indicated how early the Minister has been here.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, let us make progress. He has assured that he will whip the Minister for Finance here tomorrow. So, we understand him. I mean, this morning, the mood of the House looks good. It is not good, but it looks good. So, he should not disturb the mood unnecessarily. He should just allow the Minister for Health to do his work and exit in peace.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Minister for Health, kindly lay your Papers.

BILL — FIRST READING

Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025

An Act to establish the Ghana Medical Trust Fund to mobilise resources to finance and support the provision of specialised medical care for the treatment of persons with chronic diseases, to provide for the management of the fund and for related matters.

Presented by the Minister for Health (Mr Kwabena Mintah Akandoh). Read for the First time; referred to the Committee on Health.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the indication from the sponsors of the

Bill is that they wish this can be taken under a certificate of urgency. So, I pray that the indication—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: But, Hon Leader, the indication will be given to us by the Committee. The When the Committee reports to us, they will then tell us that due to the exigency of the Report, it prays the House takes that report under a certificate of urgency.

Mr Dafeamekpor: But the practice has been that the indication must come at this point, so that in making the referral, the added information can accompany it. So, in preparing their report, two separate reports can be prepared in respect of whether or not it should be taken under a certificate of urgency and then the report of the Committee.

Mr Speaker, I thank you.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not know why the Minister for Health has turned into a Backbencher and doing as if he wants to fly.

Mr Speaker, the taking of Bills through a certificate of urgency has become one too many in this Ninth Parliament. Even University Bills are being considered under a certificate of urgency. If they want us to do the work properly, they do not need to rush the Bill. Why do they want to rush it? Also, Chief Whip, it is the Committee that will take that decision.

But because of their numbers, they always say so, so that the Committee will bring a recommendation of urgency of the Bill. But what is urgent about some of these Bills? Chief Whip, let us do good work. The Minister for Health wants good work to be done on the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, so we do not need to rush or start it, and other interested parties will say that they were not consulted.

That is why some of the Bills are suffering. So please, let the Committee do their job and do not rush it through a certificate of urgency.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Hon Habib used to sit here. This is my Ninth year in this House. The number of Bills that he brought under a certificate of urgency as the Second Deputy Whip when he was sitting on our Side, I can list them; they are more than 35 in eight years.

Mr Speaker, but we passed every single one of them without crying. I have just done about three, and he is up in arms. That is on a lighter note. So, humbly, let the other indication be given to the Committee to deal with this matter.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well, Hon Members, as I said, the Bill is read for the First time and it is referred to the Committee on Health for consideration and report. The Committee on Health should look at the exigency of it and recommend to

the House whether we need to take it as an urgent matter. I so direct.

Ranking Member, immediately it is referred to you, we are going to work on it—*[Laughter]*— Yes.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may we revert to Statements which is item numbered 7. The indications are that we have about three Statements that you have duly admitted and prioritised for the day. One is standing in the name of the Hon Member for Ashaiman to eulogise our gallant women for qualifying for the semi-finals at the Women's Africa Cup of Nations (WAFCON).

So, Mr Speaker, if that can be taken, then the Deputy Leader too would do a joint Statement in that regard.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, for the Statement, we have the Chairman, the Ranking Member also has a similar thing, and the woman who also wants to collaborate.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Then a supportive voice from the Leader.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, so we are going to take all of them as one Statement.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, it is all good; all to eulogise the women.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Doyoe, what do you say?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, let us confirm the number of Statements. If it is three, then we are sure of the —*[Interruption]*— I am not opposed to your Statement. That we are sure of the Statement to be taken.

Because on the console, I also see one advertised in the name of Hon Ernest Yaw Anim.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: There are three advertised Statements on the console. But this one regarding our ladies is a separate one. So, we want to take that first before we come to the formal one.

Yes. So, the Chairman, the Ranking Member, and then we will talk about it.

STATEMENTS

Qualification of the Black Queens to the Semi-Finals in the WAFCON Tournament

Mr Ernest Henry Norgbey (NDC — Ashaiman): Thank you, Mr Speaker.

3.36 p.m.

Mr Speaker, it is with deep respect and national pride that I rise today, in my capacity as the Chairman for the Committee on Youth and Sports of the Parliament of Ghana, to extend a heartfelt congratulations to our National Women's Football Team, the illustrious Black Queens of

Ghana, for their outstanding and hard-fought victory over a well-determined Algerian women's national team in the ongoing Women's African Cup of Nations (WAFCON), far away in Morocco. With this triumph, the team has successfully advanced to the semi-final stage of the competition, where they will take on the host nation, Morocco, on Tuesday, 22nd July, 2025, which will be tomorrow.

Mr Speaker, this achievement is not a sporting milestone; it is a celebration of Ghanaian resilience, unity and excellence. The Black Queens have consistently demonstrated commendable resilience, focus and commitment throughout the tournament. They have indeed represented the nation with dignity and strength on and off the field. At a time when our young generation seeks inspiration and leadership, the Black Queens have stood tall as an embodiment of what can be accomplished through hard work, teamwork and belief in one's self. The team's success is a powerful reminder that the future of Ghana's sports is bright and that our women athletes continue to make us proud on the global stage.

Mr Speaker, it is worthy to note that the last time the Ghana Black Queens reached the semi-final of the Women's Africa Cup of Nations (WAFCON) was in 2016. The victory over Algeria on Saturday, 19th July, 2025, brings to an end a nine-year gap in the semi-final qualification for the Black Queens.

Mr Speaker, let me state that this remarkable achievement aligns with the Government's broader resetting agenda across all sectors of the economy, of which sports is no exception. On behalf of the Committee on Youth and Sports of Parliament, and indeed this entire august House, I salute the players, the technical team, the Ghana Football Association (GFA), the Minister for Sports and Recreation and all those who have contributed to this journey. May I place on record, today in this Chamber and across the length and breadth of our beloved country, that the Parliament of Ghana stands firmly behind the Black Queens as they continue their quest for glory. May their courage, tenacity and boldness inspire the next generation and may their triumph be a call to action for further investment in women's sports.

Mr Speaker, I take this opportunity to call on Ghanaians, both home and abroad, to rally behind the Black Queens as they prepare for their crucial semi-final match against Morocco on Tuesday, which is tomorrow.

Let us stand united in our support and encouragement for the team. Let me say *ayekoo* to the Black Queens. Well done, Black Queens. Continue to carry the flag of Ghana with pride. We believe in them and we are with them from now until the final match.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
Thank you very much. Hon Member for Old Tafo and the Ranking Member for the Committee on Youth and Sports, you can also make your Statement.

Qualification of Black Queens to the Semi-Finals of the Women's Africa Cup of Nations (WAFCON)

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (NPP — Old Tafo): Mr Speaker, I rise in my capacity as the Ranking Member for the Committee on Youth and Sports to join in applauding the heroic performance of our Black Queens, who have once again lifted the flag of Ghana high by securing a place in the semi-finals of the 2025 Women's African Cup of Nations (WAFCON).

Mr Speaker, beyond the celebration of this victory lies a story of resilience, long-term investment and sustained commitment, particularly in the often-underappreciated area of women's football. While recent support must be acknowledged, this achievement is undeniably built on the foundation laid by the previous New Patriotic Party's (NPP) Government, which took deliberate steps to reposition women's sport as a national priority. It was under the leadership of the NPP that we witnessed the revamping of the Women's Premier League through structured funding and logistical backing. It was again under the leadership of the NPP that we witnessed the construction of the

many Astro Turfs and sports infrastructure across the country, providing modern and accessible training facilities.

Mr Speaker, it was under the leadership of the NPP that we witnessed the development of female focused football policy frameworks through the Ghana Football Association (GFA), supported and encouraged by a government that believed in gender equity in sports, and targeted capacity-building programmes for coaches and female sports professionals to ensure quality growth from the grassroots to the national level.

Mr Speaker, these investments were not headlines. They were real, strategic, and visionary. Today, the fruits of that legacy are being harvested, not by any single administration, but by the nation as a whole. Let this moment remind us that national sporting success is not achieved through rhetoric or occasion based praise. It comes through consistent, non-partisan commitment to funding, infrastructure, and talent development, especially for our women.

Mr Speaker, I reaffirm our unwavering support for the Black Queens and all our national teams. I also renew the call for a bipartisan national policy on sports development, one that will protect gains made, ensure equitable investment, and preserve the momentum for the future generations.

To the Black Queens, we say *ayekoo* to you. Continue to carry the torch with pride. Ghana is proud of you, and history is being kind because of your sacrifice.

Mr Speaker, thank you so much, for the kind opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Since the ladies are now playing at the international stage, let me give the opportunity to Hon Comfort Doyoe to also either contribute or read a Statement.

Black Queens' Progress to the Semi-Finals of the Women's Africa Cup of Nations (WAFCON)

First Deputy Majority Whip (Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe): Mr Speaker, I rise with great pride and admiration to extend warm congratulations to the senior national women's football team, the Black Queens of Ghana, for their remarkable and steady progress in the ongoing Women's Africa Cup of Nations (WAFCON) tournament.

Mr Speaker, their recent triumph over Algeria in the quarter finals, a hard-fought battle that ended in a 4-2 victory on penalties, is an evidence of their discipline, resilience, and fighting spirit. This victory does not only bring glory to Ghana, but it also ignites hope in every young girl who dreams of rising through sports to represent our beloved country.

Mr Speaker, as the Black Queens prepare to face the host nation, Morocco in semi-finals tomorrow, we urge them to carry the hope and prayers of the entire nation with pride and confidence. Though some of us may be far from them physically, I want to assure the team that we are with them in spirit, supporting them with our prayers, our might, and our strength.

Mr Speaker, let us all rally behind our gallant Queens as they continue to lift high the flag of Ghana. We are proud of them and we wish them success in their upcoming clash. I wish the Black Queens well. This is woman power; it is not political power and the women are performing, so nobody should politicise them. All we need is victory. They are doing well. So, osee Black Queens! Osee Black Queens! Our prayers are with them, so we should take politics out of it and allow them focus and bring us the cup.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

3.46 p.m.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Yes, let me first identify the Member for Guan.

Mr Fred Kwesi Agbenyo (NDC — Guan): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to contribute to the Statement ably made

by my Brother, the Member of Parliament (MP) for Ashaiman.

Mr Speaker, I think it is fair that all of us will eulogise and congratulate the Black Queens for the performance they have put up so far in the Women's Africa Cup of Nations tournament going on in Morocco.

Mr Speaker, I have taken time off to watch all the three matches that the Queens played and I must say their qualification is not a fluke. They have shown that they are committed; they have prepared adequately and that is why we are seeing the kind of results we are seeing. I can only pray and hope that, even as they meet the host nation, Morocco, tomorrow, they will perform to the admiration of all and qualify to the finals of the tournament.

Mr Speaker, I want to also thank Hon Doyoe who admonished all of us to try and take partisan politics out of national sports. Ordinarily, I would have responded to my Brother from the other Side when he said we should congratulate the New Patriotic Party (NPP) for the foundation they laid for which the Black Queens are performing the way they are performing because the people of this country—For about nine years, the national team has been on sabbatical leave.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon, you are also going there.

Mr Agbenyo: I am just avoiding it.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, avoid that—So, that is what I have—

Mr Agbenyo: I only said that Ghanaians are happy that our football is back from sabbatical leave. Ghanaians will see victories as we move on now. The national team, the Black Stars, that was struggling so much to qualify to the World Cup, as we speak right now, the performance is there for all to see. I am very confident we would qualify.

But Mr Speaker, on a more serious note, as a nation, we have not paid particular attention to female football. If you check the history very well, Mr Speaker, the Black Queens is the first national team to have qualified to the World Cup. And even at that World Cup, they performed quite well. I think that we have not invested so much in terms of the infrastructure and logistics that we need to be able to bring those sports up.

Mr Speaker, I have always argued that if we pay attention to sports, especially football, this whole subject of unemployment that all of us are talking about will be able to reduce by some 70 per cent. Because in the football ecosystem, almost every professional is needed there: right from the driver to the horticulturist to the cleaner, medical doctor, pharmacist, to the engineer. So, if we pay attention, develop the infrastructure and do what other nations are doing, I believe that we can use football, in particular, to solve unemployment in our country.

So, let me end by congratulating them once again and urge them on that the whole of Ghana is behind them. We would pray for them and we would support them. My prayer is that, by close of day tomorrow, the match starts at 7 p.m., Ghana would have emerged victorious against the host nation.

Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo (NPP — Oforikrom): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to comment on the Statement.

Mr Speaker, I wish to congratulate the Black Queens for this remarkable achievement. I know this was not achieved in an easy way but through hard effort and a lot of preparation. I believe if we follow the women's sports, most of the times, we fail to support them through the needed resources. And it is my hope that the Ghana Football Association (GFA) and the Ministry of Sports and Recreation, this time around, will not fail our women, but they will make do with the resources that will push them to the finals.

Mr Speaker, watching the women play on that very day, I had goosebumps because mostly, if you watch Ghanaian matches and how we fare during penalties, one will have no doubt that it was not going to be an easy task. But then, let me single out the goalkeeper, Cynthia Konlan, who saved two penalties, which propelled us to the semifinals.

As I congratulate all the other team members for their great effort, I want to say that we should also take a second look at our investment in sports. I have seen the budget to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation and Mr Speaker, fairly, I think the Government must take a second look and support them by adding some more funds to what has been given to them. When you look at the agencies under the Ministry of Sports and Recreation, like the Winneba Sports College and other agencies, Mr Speaker, they are inadequately funded to the extent that even skills within the sports sector are inadequate. We need to train more professionals within the sports sector, so that they can also train our athletes and sportsmen.

So, on that note, I am hoping the Government and the Minister for Finance will take a look at our sports and also consider adequate funding, which will then propel us to win more trophies for this country and also enter into matches that will bring glory to this country.

Ms Jean-Marie Formadi (NDC — Biakoye): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the Statement this afternoon.

Mr Speaker, I am very proud of our female team because their performance was—In fact, for some time, I had stopped watching football, but watching them play made me feel very proud. I have to congratulate them and also plead with all

Ghanaians to pray with them. We should all support them; the Government should support them and everybody, in fact, should go on their knees and pray with them, so that tomorrow's match will be a win for Ghana because they have to go to the finals and bring the trophy home. That is what we are wishing for them.

Women are making us proud everywhere. Even here, in Parliament, women are making us proud. I pray and plead that the AstroTurfs that were previously done but were washed away by rains will be fixed because the Minister for Sports and Recreation has assured us that AstroTurfs will be fixed. The ones which were done by the previous Government but were washed away by rains will all be fixed and our women will have—

Mr Assafuah — *rose* —

Some Hon Members of the Majority: Assafuah, sit down!

Ms Formadi: Would you sit down for me to talk? Sit down and let me speak, please.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member for Biakoye, you are making a good contribution. Have you seen the little you added after all the good things you said?

Ms Formadi: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, but I did not say anything wrong.

Mr Speaker, as I said earlier, the AstroTurfs that were washed away by rains, the current Government will fix all of them—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member for Biakoye, you see—

3.56 p.m.

Hon Members, let me go back to our Standing Orders. Hon Members, we all know our Standing Orders is clear about some of these things. We do not have to mingle comments on Statement with politics. The minute you bring politics in, it means you have diluted the entire thing. So, Hon Members—

Ms Formadi: Mr Speaker, I am guided.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh — *rose* —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, one, you are a first timer; two, you are a lady and that is why I am not even giving the opportunity to the Leaders to just—Leader, let us allow it.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I was not even going to—Mr Speaker, with respect, she is my Hon Friend.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: She is your friend?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: She is my very good Friend. Well, I will even depart from her speech being

offensive of Order 93(5). I was only drawing her attention to the fact that when the Speaker is speaking, she has to sit. She was standing and the microphone was on, so I was trying to draw her attention to that.

And Mr Speaker, you rightly corrected her that she was offensive of Order 93(5) and she should just be guided. I was enjoying her until she started—If she wants to go into specifics and facts, we will not leave here because I am aware we inherited about three AstroTurfs and we left so many of them. So, please, the Hon Member should steer clear of the politics and just make her point.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us be guided, please.

Mr Bedzrah — *rose* —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Bedzrah, you see, I am not seeing you. I want to give opportunity to the first timers and the Ladies. So, let me go to Akuapem South.

Hon Member for Biakoye, are you not done? All right, just complete.

Ms Formadi: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I am guided.

All I want to tell Ghanaians is that they should all support and pray for our female players and know that the Ministry will build more AstroTurfs for sports that they will use for their trainings going forward.

So, thank you very much for the opportunity given me. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, let me go to the Hon Member for Akuapem South.

Ms Lawrencia Dziwornu (NDC — Akuapem South): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to comment on the Statement delivered by the Chairman of the Committee on Youth and Sports who doubles as a Member of Parliament for Ashaiman, and to also thank the Ranking Member of the Committee.

Mr Speaker, as a Member of the Committee on Youth and Sports, I stand here with much pride and a lot of joy in my heart, seeing the Black Queens propel to the semi-final stage of the tournament. Mr Speaker, they reached the semi-finals by defeating Algeria in a penalty shoot-out, 4-2, where Cynthia Konlan was able to make some two crucial saves on the day.

Mr Speaker, aside this feat they have achieved, it is also worthy of note that, indeed, the Black Queens have 20 members making their debut appearance on the African stage and they are already making significant strides on the stage. Aside their first match, which did not really go as expected or did not get us the results we expected, in almost every game that they have played, the women from our side have received the most valuable player awards, with Grace Asantewaa winning the Woman of the

Match award against Algeria. Also, Chantelle Boye-Hlorkah won the Woman of the Match award against Tanzania with Jennifer Cudjoe winning Woman of the Match against Mali.

Mr Speaker, this feat that the Black Queens have chalked is quite monumental because they have been able to break the nine-year hiatus which is increasing our sense of pride for football. So, I stand here to congratulate the Black Queens for the significant strides that they have made in advancing to the semi-finals. I am believing that destiny will make them lift up the trophy and bring it home at the end of this tournament.

Mr Speaker, I also want to commend the coach, Kim Lars Björkegren, for the significant effort he has put in to push the Black Queens to the semi-finals. Also, I would like to congratulate the Hon Minister for Sports and Recreation, Mr Kofi Adams, who happened to be in my constituency over the weekend. Mr Speaker, this aligns with my vision to harness and develop talent at the grassroots level in the Akuapem South Constituency.

Over the weekend, the Minister for Sports and Recreation made it a point to visit my constituency where I held a tournament for the youth. Mr Speaker, they performed outstandingly and I was brimmed with so much joy, making me know that, indeed, our national football has a lot of potential. The future is brimmed with a lot of

opportunities if we invest right in the youth that we have today.

So, Mr Speaker, on this note, I call on the Minister, our Committee and the Government to increase funding or prioritise women's football in our budgeting, so that we can have a lot of funds to support these women. Again, Mr Speaker, most of the facilities are not in good shape and I encourage the Minister for Sports and Recreation to also improve the facilities that we have in our various sporting fields to be able to support the women to advance and lift the trophy home.

Mr Speaker, on this note, I want to commend the makers of the Statement, Hon Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe being the chairperson for the Women's Caucus and my Chairman, the Ranking Member, for this all-important Statement and to congratulate the Black Queens for the feat they have chalked in the WAFCON.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
Thank you very much.

Yes, I am going for the first timers. Is that the Hon Member for Sunyani East?

Mr Seid Mubarak (NDC — Sunyani East): Thank you so much, Mr Speaker, for giving me the opportunity to make comments on

these Statements and I commend all the makers of the Statements.

Mr Speaker, this is the time that we should congratulate our Black Queens for doing this spectacular thing for Ghana. Honestly, since 1998, we have had a ladies' team in Sunyani. We have the Telecom Ladies and the female players for the Ghana Prison Service in Sunyani. They were all fighting to get to this position where our sisters have brought Ghana to. This means that the Minister for Sports and Recreation and the Minister for Education should make sure that our sisters in the lower schools can get an opportunity to play. We can harness them early, so that they can play for the Ghana Black Queens. Honestly, they have made us proud.

My sister happened to be a player who was playing for Ghana Telecom Ladies Football Team. Since then, I followed female football in Ghana. This has been her dream, to see the Black Queens getting to where they are now. We pray that they can bring the cap home. The name of my sister was Asmani Abdul Aziz. We pray that they can bring the cup home. With this, it tells us that we need to keep an eye on the Ghanaian leisure sports and not only the Ghana Black Stars.

Now that the Minister for Sports and Recreation made sure that we support the Black Queens, see where they have taken us to.

4.06 p.m.

This means that if the Minister for Sports and Recreation keeps an eye on the leisure sports, we can bring Ghana the honour that it deserves.

We say Congratulations to our ladies and our sisters. God bless our homeland, Ghana.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, my Brother?

Which constituency do you represent?

Mr Sebastian Fred Deh (NDC—Kpando): Mr Speaker, Kpando.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: All right. Hon Members, indulge me to focus on the First-timers, please.

Mr Deh: Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity. The Statements that have been made, has brought to the fore the unifying force of sports. It is one event that brings all of us together as a nation. When our women, and no less a group than a group of young women have taken this up and have done so well, we should all as a country commend them.

Mr Speaker, I am happy that this is happening on the floor of Parliament, and we are all supporting.

Mr Speaker, I would like to use this opportunity to go a bit into history. It is also important that on this day, we

use this opportunity to commend people; especially, women who have contributed in no small way in advancing sports in this country. I can mention them from historical accounts. You will notice names that stand out and have made tremendous contribution to sports, particularly soccer. These include Priscilla Hagan, Janet Egyir, Portia Boakye, and Abby Hoffman. You can also mention names like Theresa Abba, Claudia Schumann, and Elizabeth Anim for athletics and tennis. The list is quite long, so for the sake of brevity, I just have these eight names that I think have made tremendous contribution to the sports of Ghana by way of soccer and athletics. Therefore, on this important day, we must honour these people and they must go into the records of Parliament that the Nation is proud of them.

Thanks and commendation to our Minister for Sports and Recreation for doing a yeoman's job.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: We would take the last comment, but be brief. Which Constituency?

Mr Owen Kwame Frimpong (NDC — Lower West Akim): Mr Speaker, Lower West Akim.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: All right.

Mr Frimpong: Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity. With all the investments in 2016, the Black

Queens placed third. In 2018, they were knocked out in the group stage. In 2020, it was cancelled, and in 2022, they did not even qualify. In 2024, they reached the quarter final stage. Now, in 2025, we are in the semi-finals.

Mr Speaker, the good side is that my friends in my Constituency were so happy last Saturday—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members hold on. He started by saying that in 2016 we were in the third place. So, I do not see anything wrong with what is going on.

Mr Frimpong: Mr Speaker, in 2016, we placed third — *[Interruption]*— But with all the investments in 2020, we were knocked out at the qualifying stage. In 2025, we are in the semi-final stage. The good side is that my Constituents are so happy that last Saturday, they won their bets and there was no 10 per cent tax out of what they won.

[Uproar]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hold on.

Mr Frimpong: Mr Speaker, I am guided.

Mr Speaker, we pray that tomorrow—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, hold on.

Yes, Mr Baafi?

Mr Michael Baafi Okyere: Mr Speaker, the gentleman is clearly deviating from the norm. What he is doing does not hold water and it does not also encourage Parliamentary debate. We are seriously having a debate and he is diverting to betting. Does he want to encourage gambling in Asamankese? That is not a good thing to do.

Mr Speaker, he has to withdraw that part of his statement, or we will have to expunge it. **[An Hon Member: Betting is legal]**

Mr Frimpong: Mr Speaker, betting is legal and the past administration was taking 10 per cent of their win. So, they are now happy because when they win, 10 per cent is not taken. We pray that we win tomorrow's match so that they can get their money in full without paying 10 per cent on their win. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let us take the last person. Yes, who is speaking?

Mr Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh (NPP—Bosome Freho): Mr Speaker, hitherto, I would have let go the commentary on sports, because largely, sports naturally is supposed to bring people together. It is supposed to bring a nation together. It is only sports that do not know religion, colourisation, or any party.

Mr Speaker, when the impression or the mantra gets to be like we are taking credit and politicising the sports that we all enjoy, then we are bringing a huge division into Ghana.

Mr Speaker, we have been preaching “bring back the love” and we encourage all sort of things that will promote our sports and encourage our women and men.

Mr Speaker, when we begin to make it look like in a certain regime, our sporting activity was not doing well, and in a certain regime, our sporting activity is doing well, then you let other people align. **[An Hon Member: It is a fact]** No, you can enjoy the fact, but you let other people align.

Mr Speaker, if tomorrow they play and woe betides us, I am not praying for doom, but they lose, you are giving the other people the opportunity to come and hit you hard because you are politicising the sports.

Mr Speaker, I would beg and crave the indulgence of this House that we should let the spirit of promoting sports and oneness of this country rather lead the sporting activity, the Committee, and everything that we do, rather than seeking to take credit for something that they did not build in six months. When this team was called into camp, they were not even in Government. When they started selecting and scouting for the players, Members on the Majority

Side were not even in Government. So, when they come into Government for six months and they want to take credit, it becomes partisan and people want to align. The ladies out there will not want this kind of thing. Mr Speaker, let us all come together and make the Sports of Ghana better.

Mr Ebenezer Kwaku Addo (NDC—Asutifi North): Mr Speaker, as a member of the Committee on Youth and Sports, I would like to add my voice to the various Statements and contributions that has already been proffered.

4.16 p.m.

In the first place, the coach who is currently handling the women's team just took over from Nora Häuptle. And for that matter, I would first of all commend Nora for building such a strong foundation for Kim to also continue with what he came to meet. In fact, when he was taking over the team, he made a profound statement that we are not favourites, but we can surprise everyone. And the stage we have got to is indeed a surprise to Ghanaians and other contenders because we were not expecting to be at this stage. Thankfully, we have been able to reach the semifinals.

We are told that there is a strong bond off the pitch, and we are encouraging the team to continue in unity. This buttresses the point that what men can do, women can do and even do it better. So, as they go into tomorrow's match, as a country, it is

our prayer that they will lift the flag of Ghana high and come home with a trophy.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for giving me the opportunity to comment on the Statement.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Leadership and Hon Members, I think we have had enough. We have other Statements, so let me thank all of you for the contribution.

We are going to have three more Statements, but before then, let me acknowledge our children, our brothers and sisters from Tertiary Education Institutions Network (TEIN), Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST). They are also at the Public Gallery. Yes, and they are being led by Derek Cosby Owusu, the president. But how come KNUST is located at Asawase? [**An Hon Member:** Mr Speaker, because they are TEIN] [*Laughter*] Why are you located at Asawase instead of Oforikrom?

Hon Member for Oforikrom?

Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo: Mr Speaker, they are in my Constituency in Oforikrom, but I feel their visit to Parliament has been politicised because they are TEIN. So, they want to identify with Hon Muntaka. [**Some Hon Members:** Ohh!] This is the reason Asawase was situated to them.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I do not side with you. Normally, from the structure and the way we present our guests, where they come from, that is where we— As a product of KNUST, I know KNUST is located at Oforikrom. So, Hon Members, that notwithstanding, I will urge the Member of Parliament for Oforikrom to take care of them. *[Uproar]* We wish you a fruitful stay. I hope you are studying and we wish you well. Have a fruitful discussion and a fruitful stay in Parliament.

You are welcome.

[Delegation from TEIN-KNUST were acknowledged]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Is the Member for Chereponi here? Member of Parliament for Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai, at least for today, you have got the opportunity. Read your Statement.

STATEMENTS

Historic Premier League Victory of the Bibiani Gold Stars Football Club

Mr Bright Asamoah Brefo (NDC — Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai): Mr Speaker, thank you for this opportunity. I stand on Order 93 (3) and Order 67 (ff) to make a Statement on the historic Premier League victory of Bibiani Gold Stars Football Club and the urgent need for a modern sports stadium in Bibiani.

Mr Speaker, I rise in pride and honour to inform this august House of a monumental achievement from the Western North Region, specifically from my beloved Constituency, Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai.

Mr Speaker, for the first time in the history of our Region, a football club from Western North has not only broken into the Ghana Premier League, but has gone on to win the entire championship. I speak of none other than the Bibiani Gold Stars Football Club, champions of the 2024-2025 Ghana Premier League.

Mr Speaker, this is no ordinary success. It is a legacy-defining moment, a triumph of vision, hard work and unity. Bibiani Gold Stars have demonstrated to Ghana and the world that even from the youngest of Ghana's Region can emerge giants worthy of national and continental admiration.

Mr Speaker, this victory is a reflection of the collective spirit of Bibiani people; our youth, our traditional leaders, our businessmen and women, and our fans. A special mention must be made of the late Ayigbe, a loyal supporter whose memory lives on in this milestone. We also honour our chiefs, particularly *Nananom*, whose spiritual and moral support have been invaluable, and Ashanti Gold, whose partnership with the team provided the power of corporate community collaboration.

Mr Speaker, while we celebrate this historic feat, we must confront a painful truth. Despite winning the League, Bibiani Gold Stars will not be able to host Confédération Africaine de Football (CAF) Champions League matches in Bibiani. The reason is simple but deeply unfortunate. We do not have a stadium that meets CAF standards. Mr Speaker, this means Bibiani and the entire Western North Region will be denied the immense economic, social and emotional benefits of hosting continental football; benefits that include increased tourism, growth in local commerce, job creation and a renewed sense of regional pride and unity.

Mr Speaker, this situation is unacceptable. I therefore rise to strongly advocate for the immediate construction of a modern sports stadium in Bibiani; a regional sports infrastructure that can serve as a hub for not only football but athletics, youth development and national sporting activities. Mr Speaker, this must not be a temporary fix. We need a stadium with proper seating capacity, dressing room, floodlights, media facilities and accommodation for visiting teams. The people of Bibiani and the Western North have proven that they are ready. It is now the turn of the nation to match their dedication with investment they deserve.

Mr Speaker, in the spirit of national unity, celebration and recognition of excellence in Ghana football, I

humbly appeal to you and to the Leadership of Parliament to consider Bibiani Gold Stars Football Club as one of the teams to play in this year's Democracy Cup organised by Parliament.

4.26 p.m.

Mr Speaker, there could not be any better way to honour this historic victory and showcase the talent of our champions to the rest of the country and the world than to see them participate in this national event, a fitting platform to reward merit and inspire more youth across Ghana.

Mr Speaker, the time to build is now. Let this be the legacy we leave behind, not just a trophy but the tools for sustaining success for decades to come. Let us give our youths something to dream about. Let us bring continental football home to Bibiani and let us build a modern stadium that honours the dreams of our region.

Long live Bibiani Gold Stars!

Long live Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai!

Long live Ghana football and may God bless our homeland, Ghana.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Col Damoah?

Col Kwadwo Damoah (NPP — Juaben South): Mr Speaker, I am happy to associate myself with a Statement made by the MP for Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai. Indeed, Bibiani Gold Stars have done what Aduana Stars did in yesteryears by also joining the Ghana Premier League and winning the championship.

As he made a passionate appeal for a sports stadium to be built for our league champions, so that they can really play their matches at home and have maximum support around their base, I am sure it will be in the interest of the whole nation and the Government to try and build sports stadiums in all the remaining regions where we do not have one and also at places where we have league teams.

Sports, we all know, is one way of uniting our people, so if we have a way of developing and providing the necessary infrastructure, it goes a very long way to help in national unity. Once again, I want to commend Bibiani Gold Stars for this laudable achievement. It is our prayer that they will go for the continental trophy to make Western North and Mother Ghana proud.

Thank you for the opportunity and we will pray for the best for Bibiani Gold Stars.

Mr Dickson Kyere-Duah (NDC — Brekum West): Mr Speaker, I rise to commend the maker of the Statement and also commend Bibiani

Gold Stars FC for their historic Ghana Premier League win for their 27-year existence.

Mr Speaker, I would like to associate myself with the predicament described by the Hon Member, Hon Bright Asamoah Brefo, and with your leave, I will copiously make reference to paragraph 5 of his Statement, where he said:

“While we celebrate this historic feat, we must confront a painful truth. Despite winning the league, Bibiani Gold Stars will not be able to host the CAF Champions League matches in Bibiani. The reason is simple, yet deeply unfortunate. We do not have a stadium that meets CAF standards.”

Mr Speaker, in 2006, my home team, Berekum Arsenal, qualified for the CAF Cup and participated in that competition. Because Golden City Park did not meet CAF standards, the team was moved to Sunyani Coronation Park and this affected the performance of the team. The team eventually got eliminated by Petro Atletico of Angola. Two years later, they qualified again for the CAF Confederation Cup; they were sent to Sunyani, but, this time round, they withdrew from the competition. I am very confident that Bibiani Gold Stars will not withdraw because they will not have the opportunity to play at their favourite Dun’s Park.

Mr Speaker, football, we all know, is the most popular sport of the world and transcends all boundaries, be it

geographical, political, and social, it goes beyond providing mere entertainment. In fact, it is a powerful socio-economic tool that has potential to transform lives and nations.

Mr Speaker, economically, football creates a significant number of jobs from professional players, referees, technical teams and event makers. It is, therefore, important, as a country, to invest in the sport we love so much; that is football.

Mr Speaker, may I take this opportunity to make reference to the public statement recently made by H. E. John Dramani Mahama to the effect that all the six new regions would get modern stadiums. I am very confident Western North will have one and, probably, Bibiani will be the venue.

Mr Speaker, may I also take this opportunity, to plead that when these new regions are being considered, the epicentre of football in Ghana, that is Bono Region, specifically our regional capital, Sunyani, should be considered for a modern stadium as well. As well as my constituency, Berekum West, Mr Speaker, which has six Division Two clubs, namely Fetentaa, Gye Nyame, Ayimom FC, Jinijini Jaffa, Domfete Galaxy, Adom Alpha Soccer Academy, and my own football club, Eagle Soccer Academy, of which I am the proud owner and the bankroller.

Notwithstanding the fact that we have six teams in the constituency, there is not a single playing field. The teams are forced to move to either Berekum East or Sunyani West to play league matches. So, I am pleading that, as President is considering building six stadiums for the new regions and Sunyani being the epicentre to be considered, Berekum West will also have a modern facility to unearth the numerous talent we are yet to discover.

Mr Speaker, thank you, once again, and I want to commend the maker of the Statement and would want to assure him that we are solidly behind Bibiani Gold Stars and I am very confident they will do us proud when they go into the Continental African Club Championship.

Thank you. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Fred Kwesi Agbenyo (NDC — Guan): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to contribute to this Statement and also to congratulate Bibiani Gold Stars for winning the Ghana Premier League in the last edition.

Mr Speaker, in as much as I empathise and sympathise with Bibiani Gold Stars that has qualified yet cannot play their matches in their hometown in front of their supporters and that they have to travel to another place to play and also that we are calling on Government to build new stadiums across the country, it is

important that we pay attention to how we keep some of these facilities that we already have: our maintenance culture.

Mr Speaker, Accra Sports Stadium is just behind us and you can go there and see the state of the Accra Sports Stadium, that is supposed to be the “Wembley” of this nation. Mr Speaker, go to Kumasi and see the state of the Baba Yara Sports Stadium.

4.36 p.m.

I remember before the Africa Cup of Nations in 2008, a brand-new stadium was built in Takoradi. If we go there today and see the state of that stadium, I do not think that even school sports can be held in that particular facility. It is the same thing with the Cape Coast Sports Stadium, which was built before 2015. If we go there right now—

Mr Speaker, you will recall that recently, when the Black Stars had a match, Federation of International Football Association (FIFA) did not even want to allow us to play in this country. At a point, we contemplated taking the match out of our country. So, Mr Speaker, the point I am making is that even as we ask for new stadiums to be built, it is important that the ones that we have already, we take very good care of them.

Let us go to the Ho Sports Stadium. It is a stadium that has been there for all these years. Mr Speaker, if we go

there and see the state today, the fence walls are almost down, the stands are not there, and the pitch itself is not in a good state. The University of Ghana Stadium, which was built recently, Mr Speaker, the pitch is not in a good state. I am very worried about our maintenance culture as a people. We cannot be calling for new facilities when the few ones that are available to us, we are not taking care of them.

Mr Speaker, it is important that we make time, once in a while, to discuss the Ghana Premier League in this country. My Colleagues who are close to sports in this country will tell us that these days, even when a club wins the league, it is not something one wants to overly celebrate because the things that are happening in our leagues are not something I can discuss on a platform like this.

I was thinking that with the Anas exposé in football, our refereeing was going to be better than we have today. But Mr Speaker, if we go back there and see what is happening, the way matches are won on the pitches is a major problem. It is obvious that in this country, we have the raw talent, and if we invest properly and create that enabling environment, we can move our sports to where Brazil and the rest have got to. But we are simply not doing the basic things that we need to do to be able to get to the top.

So, as I celebrate and congratulate Bibiani Gold Stars F.C. for winning, I also suggest that we go back and look at where the lesser-known sports or

the teams that are at the lower level of the sports: the third division, second division and first division teams are playing.

Mr Speaker, there is something that is creeping into our country now that, again, all of us should be worried about. These AstroTurfs that we are building all over the country—How does one travel to a place like mine, the Oti Region, which is virtually a rain forest, and everybody is busy building an AstroTurf? Now, if we go and check the science behind these AstroTurfs and the effects it has on players, that is why Europe and every other place are moving away from AstroTurfs into natural green grass.

We are busy celebrating ourselves that we are building AstroTurf across the place and that is having serious effects on our players and when they even travel abroad. I think that we need to have a conversation with the Ministry of Sports and Recreation and the Ghana Football Association (GFA) to find a solution to how we can develop a sports infrastructure in this country that will be beneficial to all of us and our sportsmen and women.

With this, Mr Speaker, I thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
Thank you very much.

Let me now invite Hon Kwabena Boateng to also make his Statement. Hon, your Statement has been with us

for a while, so this is the opportune time. The floor is yours now.

Deplorable Conditions of Roads in the Ejisu Constituency

Mr Kwabena Boateng (NPP—Ejisu): I am grateful, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I rise today with deep concern and a firm sense of duty to give voice to the daily struggles of the good people of Ejisu who continue to endure the devastating impact of poor road infrastructure in key parts of our constituency.

Mr Speaker, the Ejisu-Onwe-Kwaso road, the Kokobra-Ekyem-Akokoamong road, the Ejisu-Asamang road and the Besiase-Jamasi road are not just roads. They are lifelines that connect our people to markets, schools, hospitals and workplaces. Today, these lifelines are hanging by a thread.

As far back as a year ago, work commenced on both the Ejisu-Onwe-Kwaso road and the Kokobra-Achiase road. Bridges were constructed, gutters were built, and the hopes of the people were rekindled, but those hopes are dimming once again. The machines are gone and the contractor has left the road. What was started has now stalled and the people are growing weary.

Mr Speaker, what, unfortunately, has been left for the good people of Ejisu is to endure a thick smoke of dust, deep potholes and huge gullies

created by erosion. I do not rise to lay blame; I rise to call this House to conscience, to remind ourselves that governance is a continuum and the same exists for the benefit of all, including the people of Onwe, Asieninpong, Kwaso, Kokobra, Ekyem, Akokoamong, Achiase, Asamang, Besiase-Jamasi, among others.

Mr Speaker, the people of the Ejisu Constituency, respectfully, are not asking for luxury. They are only asking for roads that will not swallow the vehicles, paths that do not flood, and communities that are not left behind. The situation has worsened with the onset of the rainy season. These roads have become traps, endangering pregnant women, school children, traders and farmers. Vehicles get stuck, transport grinds to a halt, produce spoil and the local economy bleeds quietly.

Mr Speaker, I witnessed at first hand the frustration of my constituents during a public demonstration on Monday, 7th July, 2025, led by the Concerned Drivers' Union of Ejisu. They presented to me and the MCE a petition outlining the unbearable toll that the deplorable roads have on their operations and livelihoods.

Mr Speaker, they spoke bitterly of the soaring cost of spare parts, caused by the daily wear and tear from navigating craters other than roads. They lamented their inability to drive at safe and legal speeds, leaving them

vulnerable to armed robbery and accidents, especially at night. Some are abandoning their routes altogether, further isolating the very communities we are meant to serve.

Mr Speaker, these are not exaggerations. These are realities of drivers and passengers within the Ejisu-Onwe enclave and the Kokobra-Ekyem-Achiase enclave, who wake up each day expecting their government to benefit them. While I commend the Ministry of Roads and Highways and the Ghana Highways Authority for the commencement of the construction, it is clear that mere beginnings are no longer enough. We need commitment, continuity and most importantly, completion.

Mr Speaker, I, therefore, make the following passionate appeal that the Minister for Roads and Highways and the Ministry of Road and Highways do the needful facilitations for the contractors to remobilise to the site and resume full work on the Ejisu-Onwe-Kwaso route and the Kokobra-Ekyem-Achiase road.

4.46 p.m.

Mr Speaker, we also expect works on roads like Asamang and Akokoamon which have never seen tarred roads since independence. Secondly, that permanent drainage systems be implemented to prevent erosion and flooding which further deteriorate these roads, especially during the rainy seasons.

Mr Speaker, the people of Ejisu are not demanding special treatment. They are calling for what is fair and just, the minimum standard of government any citizen would expect. As their representative, I will not relent until Government looks favourably upon us and we see machines back on site and our people reconnected to the opportunities they rightfully deserve.

Mr Speaker, this is not a partisan gimmick; it is a patriotic obligation. It is a call to act, not later, not eventually, but now. Let us rise to the moment and finish what was started for the good people of Ejisu. Let us prove once again for all that leadership listens and government still delivers.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
Yes, Hon Member for Suame.

Mr John Darko (NPP— Suame):
Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity given to me to comment on the Statement ably made by my Brother, the Hon Member of Parliament for Ejisu.

Mr Speaker, in his Statement, he has pricked the conscience of this country. The fact that the roads that have been left are causing pregnant women to more or less lose their babies. The fact that the roads that have been left undone are causing school children to abandon schools.

The fact that these roads have become traps for our children. The roads have become traps for our farmers and traders and causing a lot of pain to the people of Ejisu.

Mr Speaker, with respect, this problem is not only in Ejisu but my Brother had to bring this before the House to remind the Minister for Roads and Highways that Ejisu is still part of Ghana and that any allocations that will be made for road construction, the President and his team should never forget Ejisu. The importance of Ejisu to the country and especially to the Ashanti Region, cannot be said to be overemphasised.

Mr Speaker, the halting of this project tells us what has happened since the assumption of this Government. I can understand that the President just put his government together.

Mr Speaker, we see that in some other areas roads are being constructed but there are equally important road connections that the President must look at and one of them is the one at Ejisu.

Mr Speaker, if we move from Ejisu, one road that I believe the President and his team should never forget is the Amasaman portion of the Kumasi-Accra Road. Anybody who has used that road in the past months will tell the ordeal travellers and users of the road go through.

Mr Speaker, the past government committed a lot of money into constructing that road but since the assumption of this new Administration, that important road project has stalled and is causing travellers and people who live within that enclave a lot of pain. Another project which has also stalled and needs the attention of this House and this country is the Suame Interchange. I do not say that because I am the MP for Suame, but I say that because the delay in finishing that project is causing a lot of traffic within the Kumasi Metropolis.

Mr Speaker, the construction started well and the contractor and his workers were on site day and night working. But since 2025, we have seen the reduction of workforce on that road. We have seen that now there are just skeletal staff working on the Suame Interchange.

Mr Speaker, that particular portion of our international link is so important. It leads to Burkina Faso, the Sahelian regions, and of course the northern parts of our country where the President is from. So, it is important that some of the road construction projects like Ejisu, the Accra-Kumasi Road, and the Suame Interchange are prioritised.

Mr Speaker, when the construction of these roads is delayed, what happens is that the cost of the road goes up. This country does not have a lot of money. So, why do we continue to waste money?

Mr Speaker, when the roads are stalled, mobilisation and demobilisation cost go up. The ones that have already been done are destroyed, so when the contractor goes back, they will have to spend a lot of money to fix the road again thereby increasing the cost of road construction.

Mr Speaker, we see that when it comes to road construction, contractors always come to vary the cost. It is not because they enjoy it, but because governments spend so much time paying contractors to go back to site. So, by the time they go back, whatever they have done would have been destroyed and we have to spend a lot more money to fix them. We are a country of few. We cannot afford to be wasting resources like that, so I plead with Mr President and his team. Just like my Brother from Ejisu said, particular attention should be given to roads that have already been started, the roads that the contractors are on right now, and try to finish them for the people of Ghana.

Mr Speaker, I would like to again thank the maker of the Statement for presenting this for and on behalf of his people and I thank Mr Speaker for the opportunity to also make a contribution.

Mr Speaker, on that note, I yield the Floor.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
Yes, my Brother.

Mr Nelson Kofi Djabab (NDC — Krachi East): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to also lend my support to the Statement made by the Hon Member for Ejisu. In his presentation of the Statement, he indicated that the roads in Ejisu have become very bad in nature. I share my concern and sympathy with him. But I go forward to also state the nature of road network in my Constituency, Krachi East Constituency.

Mr Speaker, that is not different from the roads we have in Ejisu. But I was much happy to hear that he has a lot of roads which have been stalled. In my Constituency, it might interest you to hear that I cannot even boast of even one road project that has come to stall. Sometimes, I ask myself whether my people are discriminated against or we are in a different part of Ghana.

4.56 p.m.

Mr Speaker, one gets to my constituency right away from Asukawkaw through Pai-Katanga to Tokuroano and these are the major roads that one can only see. When one veers a little bit into the hinterlands, Mr Speaker, the roads have developed major holes that can be described as manholes; they are no more potholes and this is so disheartening.

Farmers go to their farms, and as hardworking as they are, their farm produce remains in the bush. They cannot cut them to the market centres.

Fishermen from the various villages cannot commute between their district capital and their villages because of the bad nature of roads. Mr Speaker, it is against this background that I agree that once we have these major challenges in our road network, efforts should be made by the Minister for Roads and Highways to ensure that all areas are equitably developed, so that the people of these areas can commute between their areas of settlement and their commercial centres.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the Statement.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. I think the people who are up on their feet are all going to talk about the roads in their constituencies. I know Manso Nkwanta has very bad roads. I know Bosome Freho also has very bad roads. Oforikrom has good roads. So, I think they are all taking advantage of the Ejisu roads.

Anyway, let me come to Manso Nkwanta. I hope you are going to lament on your—

Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (NPP — Manso Nkwanta): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I know you have already read my mind.

Firstly, I would congratulate my Brother for making such a brilliant Statement, which is at the heart of

most of us in this Chamber. Mr Speaker, as you rightly said, our road issues are of concern to many of us here, and I am not excluded because in my Constituency, our road network and the quality of roads is a big issue.

But Mr Speaker, the issue here is that we have a lot of contractors who have done work on roads in Ghana, but they have not been paid. They have raised and submitted Interim Payment Certificates (IPCs) and are waiting for payments, but they have not been paid. So, as the Hon Member from Suame indicated, we leave these roads to deteriorate further, and when the contractors go back, we will have to spend more money to get them even to the states that they were left.

Mr Speaker, one thing that we need to learn as a nation is that, once contractors work on these roads and they raise IPCs and the IPCs are certified, they become contingent on the nation to pay. So, if we delay in paying these IPCs, what it means is that it is going to cost the nation even more, because as we delay, interest continues to accrue on these IPCs. So, we might decide that today, yes, for whatever reasons, we are not paying, but interest will continue to accrue. So, indirectly, we are causing financial loss to the states, something that could have been avoided. Interest will accrue, and the roads will further deteriorate. So, Mr Speaker, it is not in the interest of the nation for us to delay paying contractors for whatever reason that we may have. We need to pay contractors to be able to fix the roads that have been assigned to them.

Mr Speaker, importantly, we need to acknowledge the fact that all the economic transformation programmes that this Government has talked about, without good and accessible roads to the productive centres, these programmes would never go as planned. Talk about all their great transformation programmes and all those, without accessible roads, these programmes will not see the light of day. So, it is in the interest of this nation for us to pay contractors, for us to have access to the productive sectors and for this economy to be transformed.

So, Mr Speaker, I am adding my voice to that of my Brother who made the Statement, that we need to look at this issue of roads construction coming to a halt because of certain reasons that we all know. We need to pay them, otherwise, it is going to cost this nation more and that is not in the interest of anyone. We will be causing financial loss to this state for something that we could have addressed in time.

I thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo (NPP — Oforikrom): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

I want to express my strong support for the Statement ably made by Mr Kwabena Boateng, the Hon MP for Ejisu, who happens to share boundaries with Oforikrom.

Mr Speaker, the deplorable state of the roads as expressed by the Hon Member for Ejisu does not just affect Ejisu, but also has consequences on Oforikrom as well, as many residents in Oforikrom use the Ejisu-Onwe road as well to their various workplaces and even to access market centres.

Mr Speaker, quite interestingly, one key programme that could have helped most of us, and I am sure if it was still functioning properly, a lot of us would not be complaining of roads, is the District Road Improvement Programme (DRIP) project. The recall of the DRIP machines to the regional administration offices has affected all of us, Mr Speaker. As I speak to you, quite surprisingly, this morning—I did not even know my Hon Colleague was going to make this Statement—my constituents called me that some of the roads in my Constituency have become so deplorable that they cannot even move out of their neighbourhoods. I remember clearly that before the DRIP machines were recalled, we were using these machines to address the situation. Quite unfortunately, we have to mobilise funds to support these communities. I remember that when the DRIP machines were functioning, there was also a fund that was being used for its operationalisation. So, we will urge the Minister for Roads and Highways to do well to get the DRIP machines back to the municipal and district assemblies, so that Members of Parliament can have access to them to

use these machines to fix the roads that central Government has not yet budgeted for or has not yet prepared to put them in better shape or asphalt them. I believe that some of these complaints will also go down.

But until then, Mr Speaker, we also pray that the Minister also considers every Member of Parliament in the Big Push Agenda, so that when he is sharing the national cake, everybody will get their fair share and there will be a reduction in the deplorable situation of our roads that we are currently facing.

On that note, I want to thank you for the opportunity, Mr Speaker.

Mr Emmanuel Kofi Ntekuni (NDC — Pru West): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for this opportunity to comment on the Statement.

Mr Speaker, this is a house of records and whatever we say here must be the true record. I just want my senior Colleague to know that there has not been any recall of the DRIP machines and all Members of Parliament here will attest to it that in our various districts, we still have all the DRIP machines.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, I want the records to reflect.

Mr Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh (NPP — Bosome Freho): Thank you, Mr Speaker—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
Hon Agbana, are you going to support him?

Mr Ayeh: Mr Speaker, I want to commend my very good Friend and Colleague, Lawyer Boateng of Ejisu.

5.06 p.m.

Quite recently, I was watching the news and I saw some good people of Ejisu demonstrating. This was disheartening. The issues they were recounting were critical. So, I want to commend my Hon good Brother for bringing this critical issue which his constituents have brought before him to this august House. I believe it is a mark of a good leader and these and many are what the constituents expect from their Members of Parliament, which I believe that he has demonstrated that he is a good representative of the good people of Ejisu. I will urge the good people of Ejisu to continue to support him because I know the more they do, the more he is encouraged to do some of these things.

Mr Speaker, like many other Members have also mentioned, the issue about roads in this country is one that we need to spend the whole day to talk about. Governments come and governments go and each and every successive government recounts the number of kilometres of roads they have added, yet there are challenges of roads in all the constituencies. Mr Speaker, if you would have opened the platform for

everybody to recount the number of roads they have in their constituencies that are deplorable or in a very bad state, every Member of Parliament here would have something to say.

Mr Speaker, I remember, one day, when we were going for a campaign, there was a community around Damascus in Bosome Freho. We could not cross because it had rained. For the whole week, students around the Damascus, Keteke, Nyamebekyere and all those areas could not move to school because it rained; it was just raining.

Mr Speaker, roads like Asiwa to Abusamso-Asamama, when it rains, in the Danso curve, it will be difficult for vehicles to even cross. From the Beposo down to the Asiwa roads, it is the same issue when it is the raining season. It becomes very dangerous and a death trap. Mr Speaker, from Morontuo down to Dompaa, crossing to Duase and ending at Ankaase is another bad road.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
Banso and Abrewa?

Nana Ayeh: Yes, that is where the Banso and the Abrewa Waterfalls go through. Mr Speaker, it is a serious challenge. Again, when we hit Anyanso and we want to go to Tebeso, we go through Sumdadieso and Besease and it is a very bad road. Mr Speaker, even when you get to Nsuaem and you want to go to Tebeso it is another bad road. Mr Speaker, the

road from Tebeso to Subriso is another bad road.

Mr Speaker, I want to urge that Government make enough allocation—I know the Minister for Roads and Highways is doing well. I know successive Ministers for Roads and Highways have done well; they have done their best. But I am asking that Government and this House, as a matter of urgency, prioritise roads and, as a matter of fact, allocate a lot of resources towards construction of roads in this matter.

Mr Speaker, it is one reason I commended the decision by the erstwhile Akufo-Addo Administration in procuring the District Road Improvement Programme (DRIP) machines. Mr Speaker, it is one of the novelties and best initiative for me when it comes to managing and dealing with the road issues.

Mr Speaker, I will urge the new Government to make enough allocation for the management and operation of these DRIP machines in the various constituencies and districts, so that we can use them to manage the situation up until we are able to have some good bitumen on those rough surfaces, for the citizens and the constituents be better off than they were.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we bring Statements to a close. Let me, on behalf of the House, thank all those who have made Statements and all of you who have

taken time to also comment on the Statements.

Leadership, is there any indication? What he just did—Do you recount who?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we have the Bill that we laid and referred. My understanding is that the Report is ready, so an Order Paper *Addendum* is being prepared for it. So, Mr Speaker, in the interim, may we suspend for 10 minutes, so that we can get the Order Paper *Addendum* ready and deal with that.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, may I urge my Colleague to—I just signalled the First Deputy Minority Whip to engage with the Majority Chief Whip. My back is not looking good enough and his back is equally not looking good. I see the Minister for Health smiling. He has been smiling all day. He should let the smile translate. So, we should engage. He knows how we engage. Mr Speaker, they should engage; our Colleagues are willing to work, but the engagement is important.

Mr Speaker, we just laid the Bill and, appropriately, you referred it. He wants us to stay on. Now, the Report is not ready, but he wants us to delay and wait on the Report. That is fine. We will help him to do it. Why is he in a hurry? He should just sit down and let me finish. He should not be in a hurry to shoot himself in his thigh. He should let me help him. So, the Hon Whip should do the talking.

We miss the Hon Minister for Health; he is in the Chamber. He should let us do the appropriate engagement; then, we would do the needful. He wants us to go beyond—It is past 5 o'clock. Mr Speaker, he understands what I am telling him.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Well, I would not mind. Leadership, I think we are all aware we are rising next week, so if there is anything that we have to do, I would not mind. I understand tomorrow we are coming at 10 a.m.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so. The indication is that we would rather come in the morning and, by 2 p.m., we can adjourn. We have the Prof Mills Memorial Lectures tomorrow and it is slated for the afternoon. That is why—*[Interruption]*—The lecture is at 2 p.m. So, I have had some prior engagement.

I am also aware of the business slated for my Hon Brothers for the morning, but I am negotiating that they should push it to the afternoon, so that, by 2 p.m. when the House is adjourned, then either Side will take up its business for the rest of the day. It is a plea that I am making to them. So, the indication is that we will sit in the morning.

But, Mr Speaker, leaving the generals to their specifics, I am only pleading that the Report is ready—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: But if the Report is not ready—

Mr Dafeamekpor: No, Mr Speaker, I only said that the Report is ready, but it must be conveyed by an Order Paper *Addendum* that is almost ready. That is why I am praying that we suspend for 10 minutes for that to be done; then, we can come back and expressly deal with this Business. I do not know why the Hon Habib Iddrisu is in a hurry to respond to this matter. I have engaged with him; we have spoken; we have an understanding and he has agreed with me. That is why he came to sit here and we engaged, yet he still wants to get up and respond to this matter.

5.16 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I pray that we suspend the House for 10 minutes.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, last week, the Majority Leader presented the Business Statement, Leadership engaged and there was every indication that we are starting at 2 p.m., except on Fridays where we will start at 10 a.m. I do not know why all of a sudden, the Majority Chief Whip is indicating that we should sit at 10 a.m. tomorrow.

Mr Speaker, even today, there were equally important assignments. We had the first Northern Conference in Tamale. The Majority Leader, the Minority Leader and all the Members of Parliament from the north were at the University of Development

Studies (UDS), Tamale, for the programme, but we did not say we should sit at 10 a.m. or 2 p.m. because of the programme.

Mr Speaker, as much as we do not have a difficulty with the other part of the Business, but we are also in a fix because we have equally assigned ourselves to do other things tomorrow morning. So, to say we will sit tomorrow at 10 a.m., Majority Chief Whip, it will be a problem for us because we have equally important meetings, where we have also assigned people and have made commitments to. Tomorrow is Tuesday and it is the normal 2 p.m. we have agreed to. The Majority Chief Whip cannot vary it on the Floor, unless we are going to have a Leadership engagement to agree to this, but this is not part of the agreement that we have. So, we can go for the 10-minute suspension. We do not have a problem with that, but we do not agree that we should sit at 10 a.m. tomorrow.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Anyway, let me—No.

Minister for Health, no, you do not have the floor—[Laughter]

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, sometimes, it is painful when I speak and Hon Habib comes back to respond in a certain manner.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Why is it painful?

Mr Dafeamekpor: It is painful because I gave good reasons why we are moving the Sitting time from 2 p.m. to 10 a.m.—[Interruption]—Please, I listened to you. I gave very good reasons we are proposing to move the sitting time from 2 p.m. to 10 a.m. tomorrow.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Leader, please, let us suspend the House for 20 minutes. We will discuss that. The House is accordingly suspended.

5.19 p.m. — *Sitting suspended*

6.02 p.m. — *Sitting resumed*

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:

Hon Members, kindly resume your seats. Yes, let me welcome you, Leadership?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we have Order Paper *Addendum*. Table, if you may make available to—It is being distributed and it is also being uploaded.

Mr Speaker, may I pray that we move to Order Paper *Addendum* containing items numbered 1 to 6. Mr Speaker, with your leave, I pray that we take item numbered 1 on the Order Paper *Addendum*. Item numbered 1 (i) and (ii) together. I thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Members. Let me respectfully ask you to turn to the Order Paper *Addendum* —

Presentation of Papers 1. So, let me invite the Chairman of the Committee on Health.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Chairman and the Vice Chairman are unavoidably absent. So, Mr Speaker, in pursuant with our own Standing Orders, a Member of the Committee can present the Report. So, Mr Speaker, the Member is able and capable of presenting the Report. I thank you.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not know what the essence of us going on suspension for 20 minutes is? We do not have the Chairman of the Committee and the Ranking Member is also not here and they are electing to get a Member of the Committee to do this. So, why the rush?

Mr Speaker, if this Report is so important, the Chairman or the Ranking Member should be here to do it, Mr Speaker. Why the rush? If the Chairman and the Ranking Member are not here, then we should take an adjournment because it means that they are not ready for it.

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, thank you very much. I refer my Colleague to Order 215 of our Standing Orders. Mr Speaker, I read 215(3)

“A Motion shall be moved by the Chairperson or any other Member of the Committee upon presentation of the report to the House for consideration and adoption or otherwise of the report”.

So, he is a Member of the Committee and it is within his right to present the Report to the House. So, I think it is not out of place for any Member of the Committee to do this. So, Leader, please allow the Member of the Committee to exercise his right. Thank you very much.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think my Colleague needs to read the Order he just referred to very well. Order 215(3). He said “A Motion shall”. What we seek the Chairman to do, is it a Motion? He should read it well. That is not a Motion. You cannot refer me to an Order and just quote the Order—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Leader, read the heading.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, it is a report of a Committee and the Order 215(3) he quoted says that “A motion shall be moved”. Mr Speaker, what we seek to do here is to present the Paper. It is not a Motion yet because the Minority Whip said — Mr Speaker, if you check the Order Paper *Addendum* 1(i), it is the Report of the Committee. That is the first item. So, Mr Speaker, if it is 1 (i), and (ii), they are not Motions and for that matter—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Leader, the heading is right. Report of a Committee. So, *[Laughter]*

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, the reference is actually to

215(2). Mr Speaker, with your permission, I read:

“The Committee shall consider and adopt the report prior to the presentation of the report to the House and the report shall be signed by the Chairperson and the Clerk to the Committee”.

Mr Dafeamekpor: So, Mr Speaker, what exactly is the litigation here? What roadblock are they mounting? That the report has not been appropriately signed? Or, that the report cannot be presented to the House? So, let us be clear. The person who is amounting the litigation, let us hear him clearly then we can counter. I am can hear different voices on the matter.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, fortunately, it is clear. It did not say that it should be signed for. It says “signed by”.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Deputy Whip I believe if you have been in this House before, you come across that most of the reports are signed for. It has been a standard. I am not saying that —

Mr Shaib: I am not disputing that that has been the standard. Mr Speaker, what I am saying is what I am picking from the Standing Order. Mr Speaker, I know that this House operates with this Standing Order. If there is a departure that, for the purposes of Speaker’s directives and Mr Speaker, it has a sequel of

someone referring you to the Standing Order. The Standing Order says clearly. It did not say “signed by”. It says signed by a particular person and that is the Chairperson.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think my Colleagues on that Side should understand that in Parliament, we are masters of our own rules. So, you cannot elect to make an argument based on a particular Order when you offend the other.

6.12 p.m.

So, if he was referring us to Order 215(3) to make a point that any Member of the Committee can present the Report, my Colleague was also telling him that Standing Order 215(2) says that it should be signed by the Chairman, not for the Chairman.

So, if he wants us to continue, we can do so and leave some of these litigations, but if he also wants to make up his point, then we would also be able to make a point that it should not be signed for, but signed by the Chairman.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, one, we are confronted with the request to lay Papers in the Order Paper *Addendum*. The laying of Papers is governed by Order 96 of our Standing Orders.

Mr Speaker, let me, with your leave, read what Order 96 says,

“Presentation of Papers—

A Paper may be presented to the House only by the Speaker, the chairperson of a Committee, a Member, a Minister or a Head of an Independent Constitutional Body.”

Mr Speaker, may I further refer the House to Order 6 of our Standing Orders, the interpretation provision. Mr Speaker, a Paper is defined. A Member is also defined. So, the argument that a Member of a Committee who is copiously captured under Order 96 to have the mandate to present a Paper to this House is untenable, is totally unfounded. There is no basis to make any such argument. A Member is mandated by our Standing Orders to have the capacity to lay a Report or lay a Paper on behalf of the Committee.

Mr Speaker, further under Order 215(3) that my Brother quoted earlier, it is to buttress the fact that it is not merely a Paper that is being laid, but it is actually to give way to the presentation of a Committee Report. And the presentation of a Committee Report is also captured under Order 215. Mr Speaker, with your leave, let me read 215(1) first of all. And the headnote is Report of Committees.

“1. The deliberations and recommendations of a Committee shall be presented to the House in the form of a report.”

The Papers are the conveyance by which the reports are presented on the Floor. And that is why in order 215(3), it says this:

“A Motion shall be moved by the Chairperson or any other Member of the Committee upon presentation of the report to the House for consideration and adoption or otherwise of the report.”

So, Mr Speaker, the terms of Order 96, if we marry it with Order 215(1) and (3), apply *pari passu* to the matters before us. So for anybody to say that the Member, so prepared to present the Paper and subsequently the Report, has no capacity is totally unfounded, and is an abuse of the process. Now, we can only be invoking Order 215(2) if the Report that we seek to lay and adopt is unsigned. The Report has been appropriately signed.

So, Mr Speaker, with all due respect, this is a journey to nowhere. I pray that we proceed with this matter, so that we can do some Business.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
Yes?

Mr Kwame Anyimadu-Antwi:
Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I think that the Majority Chief Whip is not helping the Minister. He would have done worse. The effect of the Rules is clear.

It is the Majority that is referring us to the Rules that the Report can be presented by any Member. He cannot jump two and come to three when he refers to 215. Order 215(2) says that the Report must be signed by the Chairman.

The Minister comes in hurriedly that he wants this Bill to go through. Instead of picking an argument that will help the nation that we are in a hurry to present this Bill, he wants to go by the Rules. The effect—*[Interruption]*—I have not finished. Please sit. I have the floor.

The effect of what he is saying it is that with a Report, when the Chairman sits and presides over the Committee, and then it comes to the House, any Member can present it. But the Rules do not say that any Member can sign a Report. It is the Chairman and the secretary to the Committee that 215(2) says that they have to sign a Report. Now, does he have a Report that is signed by the Chairman? All that the Frontbench is telling us is that the Chair and the Vice Chair are unavoidably absent. Where are they? Why the rush?

The Minister came in, and he did not marshal all these people. I am not sure even if the Chairman sat at the Committee level to decide on the Report that they are presenting. He is not helping the Minister. He should pick a better argument.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, Hon Anyimadu-Antwi did not listen

to me, or perhaps he is not following the argument. The argument is not that the Report is not signed. That was a secondary argument. The primary argument was that the Member cannot lay the Report, and that is the issue we are dealing with. So let us deal with the primary issue first. The issue is that they claim that the Chairman did not sign the Report; the Report has been signed. His litigation is that it was not signed by the Chairman. It was signed for the Chairman. And I am saying that does not invalidate the Report, with all due respect. It does not.

Show me the law that says that when the Report is not signed by the Chairman, the Report is invalidated. Please, if he is speaking across—He can decide to litigate this matter. And I can see the mood. So with all due respect, Mr Speaker, we have engaged in this matter since morning. So, if he comes and he changes colour and he wants to do what he is doing, I am ready for him, with all due respect. But the Report will have to be taken. Yes, I have listened to myself because what they are doing is not fair.

So, Mr Speaker, the Rule clearly mandates a Member to present a Report. In fact, last week, a Member presented a Report. A Member did. A Member presented a Paper on behalf of the Committee and subsequently—*[Interruption]*—They should please stop shouting across. I listened to them carefully. So, a Member of this House belonging to a Committee,

whose Committee's Report was ready, presented it just last week.

And they get up and say that we are in a hurry. Nobody is in a hurry. It is the sponsor of the Bill who comes to the House and informs the House that, given the exigencies and the matters contained in the memorandum to the Bill, it is urgent that this Bill be considered expressly. Is that something new that has been introduced on this Floor? No.

Indeed, I have sat on the Left Side for eight years. We carried more than 35 Bills under certificate of urgency on that Side. — *[Expunged by order of Mr Speaker.]*— So, there is no basis for the argument emanating from this Side regarding the Report that is ready to be carried. So, Mr Speaker, we are entirely in your hands for direction in the matter.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader, let me hear you.

Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, thank you.

I followed the argument while in the office, and I thought I needed to come in to add my voice for us to find a way forward. Mr Speaker, I am not going to talk law. I am not going to talk procedure. I am going to talk practice. The fortunate thing both Sides have as their equity is that both Sides have once been in government before.

6.22 p.m.

The practice, as I know, is that Ministers of State—and I say so with a lot of deference to my respected Colleague, Mr Akandoh—do prior engagement. There is a good reason we have five Leaders and we have Committee leaders.

Mr Speaker, we do prior discussion for some of these urgent matters coming from Cabinet. I have been with my Colleague, the Majority Leader, all day today. No such communication regarding this Government policy was discussed with me. There is this mindset that they are majority, so they will have their way and they should not worry, whether they are even up to 30 here. It is like if the Minority wants to assert itself, then they take us to social media that we are obstructing Government Business.

At that time the five of us took that responsibility, we knew that insults were part of it, I in particular. This is not about who says what on social media against me. As long as I know my conscience is clear, I leave this Chamber; I will attend my evening mass, pray to my God, take my communion, go and sleep. I do not care about somebody insulting me or somebody's propaganda. Let us serve our country. If there is an important policy like the healthcare—And Hon Minister, with the greatest respect, we have our own *esprit de corps*. We have a relationship; none of the Hon Members here is an enemy to us.

Have we engaged for us to even appreciate?

Mr Speaker, I will not mention the name of that Minister, but there is only one Minister who, when has difficult situation, will come for discussion and let us know what it is. I just had a briefing from my Colleague on this matter. Hon Rockson, with respect, our job is to help the Majority function. Our job in Minority—He was telling people to be quiet. He who comes to equity must come with a clean hand. Mr Dafeamekpor must hear me. We are in this together and the right thing must be done.

Mr Speaker, even as they are pushing, I heard the Rules and I do not want to talk about the Rules. One cannot place something or nothing; it would fall. The Rule talks about laying and any Member can lay, but something must trigger. The document must be wholesome before it is laid. A document cannot appear with a signature; which signature we do not know whose is it. Then he says that it has been signed by any Member, so it is been signed for the Chairman, so it has to be laid. I do not want to place too much emphasis on law, but today is not the last day of doing Business, Chief Whip. Whatever discussion that has been had; I do not think that it was sufficient enough to carry the House on board.

Mr Speaker, it is not sufficient enough to carry all of us on board.

Besides, look at their numbers. The Majority says it wants to do something under a certificate of urgency, but, on their own Side, if we check in this Chamber, do we even have the quorum to sit, let alone quorum to take decisions. So, I would plead with them that it is their Government policy and the Government has its priorities; nobody will stand in their way, but let us allow consensus for this. This is democracy. Nobody is stampeding them on this Side of the House.

Mr Speaker, in fact, the Ranking Member, Dr Nana Ayew Afriye, is the most reasonable Ranking Member one can have. Maybe at the risk of making a disclosure, when we get hard on him, he is the one who is able to tame the Caucus and say this is health matters. Let us do it this way. They should ask him. Maybe, I must reveal this: anytime we get hard on him, he says we, the Leaders have put me there as Ranking Member and he thinks that we should support Mr Akandoh. I would not want to create a certain impression that the Minority is being reasonable, so that we play to the gallery.

Mr Speaker, it is a big no. We have the capacity, as a House, to sit and jaw-jaw, come back tomorrow, go through it, and then allow—We did University for Development Studies Bill, 2025 under a certificate of urgency. They should go and check the civil society organisations (CSOs). They were all over at the UDS—[Interruption]—Yes, but I am

saying that we did it under a certificate of urgency. Yes, that is what we did. We passed that Bill and, today, they took credit for it in Tamale that they passed that Bill—*[Laughter]*

Mr Speaker, go and check what the CSOs were telling Parliament; it was as if Parliament is a rubber stamp Chamber even when we had gone through it. So, let us take it easy because there are external stakeholders who have interest in the affairs of the state, not only us. So, if they come and say that the Minister says it should be under a certificate of urgency, then the next impression is to set an agenda that the Minority is against the Majority, and then—No, health care is critical.

Mr Speaker, we will support them, but we must understand what we need to do. We do not have the numbers; I would appeal to my own classmates and study mates; this is not a time to break shoulders over this matter. I know the burden on the Majority Chief Whip; we have been there before. The Minister has come and the Government wants something done, but there are times that I have gone back to the Jubilee House to tell the President to allow me to build consensus and the President had obliged.

The Hon Minister can do the same, so let us take it easy. Let us go, come back, and deal with it. Look at the Bill; if, indeed, it is such that, in spite of having the Health Insurance Act,

2012 (Act 852) and how people are having access to our health insurance facilities, we need to pass this Bill through certificate of urgency, it should be and it would be. But this approach now, I think the well is poisoned. Let us cure the poison in that well and let us not attempt to strictly use law. Let us invoke our own practice.

Mr Speaker decided to suspend Sitting for some 20 minutes. I do not think that the suspension has helped because Majority Leader is not here. I was not in the Chamber. The two of us have not spoken and I think that that which is in parts must be done away with, so that the whole can be invoked for perfection. I am sure the Majority Chief Whip understands this.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Mr Dafeamekpor, hold on; I will come to you.

Hon Members, I think when we went on suspension, we met and discussed—Looking at what is going on, I may have to plead with you to just take the Report and we hold on with it for further discussion. I think that is what we discussed at Conclave. So, if we can take the Report, then we will hold on with it for further discussion.

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, I respect the Chair very much and I may want to call upon Mr Speaker to rule on Order 215(2), especially when the Majority

Frontbench threatens. I cannot understand this. If one is wrong, he is wrong. They have to use other means, but what does Order 215(2) say? That is what I want to say.

6.32 p.m.

The Report must be signed by the Chair and this was not signed by the Chairman, so the Report is not properly before the House. Mr Speaker, that is all I am saying.

Mr Dafeamekpor —*rose*—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, please, I do not want us to go the way we are going. Majority Leader, please, let us not litigate on this.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, these are very important matters, with all due respect, so let me respond.

Mr Speaker, this Bill was initially brought to the House and the decision was that we should do pre-laying consideration. The Committee met this weekend, yesterday and Saturday, both Sides. So, for the Minority Leader to suggest that the sponsors of the Bill have failed to consult and engage is totally false. It is totally false. He is not a unitary Minority; he leads a group, so when officers of his group have been engaged, he cannot do that. He cannot do that—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Dafeamekpor, I—

Mr Dafeamekpor: No, Mr Speaker, he has said very terrible things; terrible things which touches on the Majority. He cannot do that. When we engage, he cannot come to the Floor and run us under the bus. He cannot do that. So, I am helping my Minister—He has decided to do politics and I am saying that even the grounds he is invoking, he does not have the grounds.

The Report has been prepared and laid and it is ready for presentation, so, Mr Speaker, I am saying that we have done adequate consultation on the matter. We built consensus on the matter and we have been sitting for the past four hours. We built consensus on this matter. It was as a result of the consensus building that we prepared the Order Paper *Addendum*. The Order Paper *Addendum* was not prepared *in vacuo*; we consulted.

Mr Speaker, the suggestion that we have not consulted nor built consensus on the matter is inaccurate; it is most inaccurate.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I think the Minority Leader said something that at certain points in time, we do not need to go strictly by the law. We have been doing Business here on consensus building, so, Majority Chief Whip, like I said during the suspension, we can start, but we would not end it today. We can start and probably continue later. I think we can still consult more. I do not think it is anything that we have

to—Let us do more consultation and probably, we will address this issue without this kind of litigation. It would not help anybody, please. I will not rule on this. Let us build up the consultation and see how best we will be able to handle it, if not today, tomorrow. Please, I beg of you.

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, as you first directed, we can lay the Report while we engage our Colleagues on the other Side, so that at the end of the day, when the Report is taken, we will come back to you on whether to continue or adjourn. Let us lay the two Reports, while we engage each other, so that we will see the way forward.

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Anyimadu, I beg of you.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think, sometimes, the Majority Chief Whip needs to control himself with regard to some of these issues. When we were engaging, none of us adverted our mind to the signing of the Report. When our attention was drawn to it, the Majority Frontbench needed to relate well, so that we would see how best this matter can be handled.

Mr Speaker, in any case, they are the same people who referred to Order 125; we did not refer to that. They stated Order 215(3); when I raised the issue that the Chairman was not there,

then he quoted the Standing Orders. So, the Majority Chief Whip has said so many things that even offends the Minority Leader.

If he had engaged us, our Minority Leader was not there. So, when he raised the issue, we were supposed to brief him and carry him along, but he cannot use certain words as if he is standing against Government Business or he does not want Government Business to move on.

So, Majority Chief Whip, I think for some of these issues, if you want us to relate, do not get angry over certain things. Mr Speaker, because of what he has done, it will be very difficult for this Report to be laid. Now, cooperation has suffered and engagement has collapsed.

Mr Speaker, for the record, they should tell us who signed the Report because they said “for”. If we read our Standing Orders very well, Order 215(2), Mr Speaker, with your permission, it says:

“The Committee shall consider and adopt the Report prior to the presentation of the report to the House and the report shall be signed by the Chairperson...”

It says, “shall be signed by the Chairperson”, while Order 215(3) says:

“A Motion shall be moved by the Chairperson or any other Member of the Committee...”

In Order 215(2), it did not say it can be signed by any other person. It said “it shall be signed by the Chairperson”. So, Mr Speaker, the Report we are going to take, who signed that Report? This Report cannot be laid. Where we are at the moment, we cannot lay the Report because we would be offending our Rules. So, they should make it known to us. The Majority Chief Whip should tell us who signed the Report. They should let us know who signed the Report first.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Leaders have a responsibility to support you to oversee the House as the Speaker.

Mr Speaker, the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill is what the Majority Whip—Mr Speaker, I was thinking that the Minority Leader would listen and be guided to take a cue from you that probably, they should allow the Report to be laid today, but we would only limit ourselves to the Second Reading of the Bill, so that we can thoroughly debate the policy principles.

The urgency of the Bill is not in the Bill; it is in those persons suffering chronic diseases who need our intervention as a country.

6.42 p.m.

I am saying Second Reading. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, at this stage, we can take the two Reports, so that—*[Interruption]*— Mr Speaker, let us take the two Reports.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, when it boils, it cools down. And my Hon Brother, Classmate, and study mate knows. He used to be here. Those days, he used to wear braces and we would see him perspiring.

Mr Speaker, I believe that occasionally, things heat up; it is part of the protocols in the House. I believe that we have done major Businesses, even with fewer numbers and a less combustive atmosphere. I believe that my Brothers— we have reached out to them since last week, over the weekend, this morning and this afternoon. So, let me plead with them that, like Hon Haruna Iddrisu has submitted, and like Mr Speaker, yourself, directed in Conclave, we take the two Reports, then we can come back tomorrow, given the mood of the House, to go through the Consideration Stage and take the Third Reading. Mr Speaker, I humbly submit.

My former Chairman, and now Ranking Member, Senior Anyimadu-Antwi should drink cold water and let his gut come down, so that we can do this matter and handle Business for the day. I thank you, Mr Speaker. The Minority Leader has just come back. He went to take cold water. Everybody should calm down. Our hearts will cool down so that we can deal with this matter. Mr Speaker, I thank you.

Senior Anyimadu-Antwi, I thank you for this opportunity. He and I being the Members of the same Committee, have done Businesses. We did things in his absence. I move Motions on his behalf. Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, – Yes, Hon Anyimadu-Antwi?

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Yes, Mr Speaker. I am not asking much. I tried to draw the Majority Chief Whip's attention to the fact that these are the Rules. He is saying that I am doing politics by that, and I take offence to that. I want him to withdraw that statement and apologise. He must know that I am not doing politics and that I am a member of the Standing Committee and he was a member too. We drew up these Rules and we have to use the rules for our benefit. If something is wrong, it is wrong. He cannot put on something else if there is nothing. We cannot multiply zero by a number and get anything. It should be zero.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the principle is that *ex nihilo nihil fit* "One cannot put something on nothing and expect it to stand. We do not seek to put something on nothing. Everything is in its place. But the comment that affects him — **[An Hon Member:** Repeat the Latin]—*Ex nihilo nihil fit*. [Laughter]. One cannot put something on nothing and expect it to stand—*Benjamin Leonard MacFoy v United Africa Company*

Ltd, Lord Denning. Mr Speaker, the part of my speech that affects the Hon Anyimadu-Antwi, let the *Hansard* be directed to expunge that from the records. I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Records, please expunge that aspect.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, Paapa Owusu-Ankomah, sometime in 2013, when we came to this House, called us over there at the coffee area and said that when we are in opposition we should act as though the next day we will come to power. He did so for a good reason that we do not drag matters even where government is; there is a limit to it. A point in time when things were tough, Mr Ken Ohene Agyapong came in and we thought he was going to hit hard at government; that was 2015. He introduced this principle of systems and policies, not National Democratic Congress (NDC), not New Patriotic Party (NPP); we should solve the problem.

Mr Speaker, on the strength of this and the posture of the Hon Majority Chief Whip and what our Hon Senior Haruna Iddrisu has just said, I think it is alright for us to proceed with the laying of the Paper and the presentation of the Report.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. I thank all of you.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker just to be sure that 187 is not

always 187. This is Parliament. This equity must be remembered.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let me now invite you to take the Order Paper *Addendum*, — Presentation of Papers. So now a Member of the Committee who has been designated to do so will now do so.

PAPERS

By Mr Mohammed Adamu Ramadan on behalf of the Chairman of the Committee

- (i) Report of the Committee on Health on determination of the urgency of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025.
- (ii) Report of the Committee on Health on the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, are we to take the Motion?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we will take the Motion numbered 2.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: By the Chairman of the Committee. So, Hon Member, you do us the honours.

MOTION

Suspension of Standing Order 104 (1)

Mr Mohammed Adamu Ramadan on behalf of Chairman of the

Committee (Dr Mark Kurt Nawaane): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I beg to *move*:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the Motion is given, the Motion for the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Health on the determination of the urgency of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025 may be *moved* today.

Mr Alexander Roosevelt Hottordze (NDC—Central Tongu): Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Now, we will take the substantive Motion.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may we take the Motion numbered 3?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes. So, Chairman, will you take the substantive Motion listed three in today's Order Paper *Addendum*.

Yes. So, Chairman, will you take the substantive Motion listed 3 in today's Order Paper *Addendum*?

6:52 pm

MOTION

Determination of the Urgency of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025

Mr Mohammed Adamu Ramadan
on behalf of the Chairman of the Committee: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That the Hon House adopts the Report of the Committee on Health on the determination of the urgency of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025.

Mr Speaker, while I present this Report, I urge the *Hansard* to capture the entire Report as though it has been read.

Mr Speaker, this Report is in two folds. The first Report on the question of whether or not the Bill be taken under a certificate of urgency, and the main Report. Mr Speaker, as to the determination of the issue of certificate of urgency, the Committee determined that the issues are such that the Bill be taken under a certificate of urgency.

Mr Speaker, the Committee strongly believes that taking the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025 under a certificate of urgency is justified, and we urge prompt consideration and passage of this critical legislation.

Mr Speaker, given the wide stakeholder consultations undertaken prior to the formulation of the Bill,

and having regard to the impending health crisis given the upsurge in chronic and non-communicable disease cases, the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025 be considered under a certificate of urgency to facilitate the operationalisation of the Fund for the benefit of Ghanaians.

I respectfully submit, Mr Speaker.
[Hear! Hear!]

Introduction

The Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025, was laid in Parliament and read the First time on Monday, 21st July, 2025 by the Hon Minister for Health, Mr Kwabena Mintah Akandoh. The Rt Hon Speaker referred the Bill to the Committee on Health for consideration and report.

The Rt Hon Speaker further directed the Committee to determine whether the Bill was of an urgent nature, and should be taken through all the stages in one day in accordance with article 106(13) of the 1992 Constitution and Order 160 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

The Committee having regard to the referral made by the Rt Hon Speaker, met with the Hon Minister for Health and officials of the Ministry on Monday, 21st July, 2025 to determine the urgency of the Bill.

Reference Documents

The Committee made reference to the following documents during its deliberations:

Determination of the Urgency of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill 2025

- i. The Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament
- iii. Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025

Observations/Recommendations

Rising Burden of Chronic Illnesses

According to the report of a survey released in November 2024 by the Ministry of Health, the Ghana Health Service and the Ghana Statistical Service in collaboration with development partners, using the World Health Organization's STEPwise approach and tools, it was revealed that Non-Communicable Diseases (NCDs) account for 45 per cent of deaths in Ghana. The survey was conducted in all 16 regions and 385 communities among 5,438 participants aged between 18 and 69 years.

The Committee noted that the high cost of treatment of NCDs like cancer, heart disease and kidney failure pose a major challenge to patients, accounting for the high mortality rate.

The Bill, therefore, seeks to provide access to financial support and resources for the provision of specialist healthcare services to totally reduce the alarming rate of deaths associated with chronic diseases and NCDs.

Gaps in the Current Healthcare System

The Committee observed further that the National Health Insurance Scheme does not cover many specialist-level treatments. The Ghana Medical Trust Fund, therefore, bridges the funding gap in current healthcare financing systems to reduce the rate of mortality among patients of chronic diseases.

Stakeholder Consultations on the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Initiative

The Hon Minister informed the Committee that a Technical Taskforce was constituted to facilitate the operationalisation of the Medical Trust Fund initiative. The Taskforce comprised academics and practitioners in health-related fields, as well as a representative of the Attorney-General's Department. The Committee was apprised of the extensive stakeholder engagements undertaken by the Taskforce prior to the formulation of the Bill. Representatives of Civil Society Organisations, health related associations and other stakeholders made inputs into the Bill. The Taskforce also undertook a survey to solicit information from the general public for inclusion in the Bill.

Reasons for the Passage of the Bill Under a Certificate of Urgency

Humanitarian Concerns

The Government of Ghana is compelled to intervene in the healthcare sector, particularly in

addressing the growing burden of NCDs that disproportionately affect the elderly and vulnerable populations. The alarming rate of deaths and suffering due to NCDs necessitates urgent action.

Support for Healthcare Financing

The importance of this Bill lies in its potential to provide critical financial protection to citizens, especially the elderly, who are often forced to bear exorbitant costs for treatment, leading to financial ruin and trauma. The current situation is dire, with a high death toll steadily increasing due to the unaffordability of healthcare services. Specifically, statistics by the World Health Organization reported that NCDs account for about 43 per cent of deaths in Ghana, underscoring the gravity of the situation. The cost burden on families is immense, and the excruciating pain endured by elderly citizens suffering from NCDs is unacceptable. It is imperative that the Government takes immediate action to address this crisis. The Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025, offers a timely solution by providing an alternative source of funding to support the healthcare needs of citizens. By establishing a sustainable funding mechanism, this Bill would help reduce morbidity rates, alleviate financial burdens on families, and improve healthcare outcomes.

Conclusion

Given the urgency of the situation and the potential impact of this Bill, there is no better time than now to

take decisive action. The Committee strongly believes that taking the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025, under a certificate of urgency is justified, and we urge prompt consideration and passage of this critical legislation.

The Committee, therefore, recommends that given the wide stakeholder consultations undertaken prior to the formulation of the Bill and having regard to the impending health crises risk given the upsurge in chronic and non-communicable disease cases, the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025 be considered under a certificate of urgency to facilitate the operationalisation of the Fund for the benefit of Ghanaians.

Question proposed.

Ranking Member of the Committee (Dr Nana Ayew Afriye): Mr Speaker, I associate myself with the Committee's Report. However, with the urgency that this Bill needs to be treated, we were clear and we want to put it on record that there was a sharp division on the financing of this Bill. We will say that, yes, it is urgent; yes, we will support you; we will help you to execute Government Business, but there is a very challenging phenomenon in clause 3 (a), which is still worrying, regardless of how urgent it is.

I am talking about the urgency, and I am saying that I associate with the urgency of this. However, it was documented, and I want to say, before

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I sit down, just as I said in the Committee, that it is urgent, but there is a problem of how to fund this Trust. I have only documented it along the urgency.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:

Thank you very much. Hon Members, the Motion numbered 3 has been moved and it has been seconded. It is now before the House for consideration.

Mr Akwasi Konadu (NPP — Manhyia North): Mr Speaker, thank you very much. I rise to comment on the Report just being laid about the determination of the urgency of the Ghana Medical Trust Bill, 2025.

Mr Speaker, while we would like to support the urgency, I would like to speak to the matter, and I raise an issue with point numbered 3.2 of the Report, which speaks about the gap in the current health system that we have.

Mr Speaker, the gap we talk about here is the addressing of non-communicable diseases. Mr Speaker, we already have a health insurance system that takes care of our health issues in the country. If there is any urgency to introduce another system, why not strengthen the already existing health insurance that we do have? However, that is the urgency, but there already exists an Authority that caters for the health of Ghanaians. What is the need of us

creating another Trust Fund to cater for the same Authority that exists? But consideration of Bills is always done with the Memorandum that is attached to it.

Mr Speaker, the Memorandum that is attached to this Bill that is making us associate ourselves with the urgency is the need of it addressing non-communicable diseases in the country. Mr Speaker, yes, over the past decade, non-communicable diseases have been a bane on the population, contributing almost about 44 per cent to 47 per cent of mortality of individuals. If there is a Bill, regardless of the fact of the existence of an Authority that caters for that, and is to address that particular aspect, we would like to associate ourselves with the urgency of it. But I will delve deep into the main Report when it is being laid on the Floor.

With these few words, I associate myself with us considering this Medical Trust Fund Bill by the Hon Minister for Health, Hon Kwabena Mintah Akandoh, under a certificate of urgency.

I so submit, Mr Speaker.

Thank you.

Mr Francis-Xavier Kojo Sosu (NDC — Madina): Mr Speaker, I rise to comment on the Report on the determination of the urgency of this Bill and the need for us to take the Bill under the certificate of urgency.

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Mr Speaker, I would particularly want to limit myself to paragraph 4 of the Report. Paragraph 4 of the Report gives two crucial reasons why we need to take this Bill under a certificate of urgency. The first one is humanitarian concerns and the second one, the need for health care financing; to have a dedicated financing option to take care of persons who are suffering from chronic diseases.

Mr Speaker, it is gainsaying that as Members of Parliament, we are always confronted with this situation where people in our various constituencies would come to our office sometimes suffering from chronic ailments. And it is so difficult to raise sufficient funding for such people. Mr Speaker, as we speak today, people are getting ill. Yesterday, people had conditions. Today, they have conditions. Tomorrow, they are going to have conditions. And every day, people are writing to us and coming to our offices, seeking assistance. Every time we are being called to Korle Bu Teaching Hospital, Greater Accra Regional Hospital, and the University of Ghana Medical Centre to support conditions that oftentimes we are unable to do.

Mr Speaker, I believe that for humanitarian concerns, let us support His Excellency, the President, who is very minded of taking care of these very urgent situations that are in our country, so that we take this Bill under a certificate of urgency.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the Report.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko (NPP — Effia): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to contribute to this Report that speaks to the need to treat this Bill under a certificate of urgency.

Mr Speaker, I have read through the entire document, and inasmuch as, as a Ghanaian, I am interested in governments coming up with a policy or a Bill to deal with this, the matter of urgency in terms of the documentation is difficult for me to fathom.

Mr Speaker, if we take point 3.1 of page 3 of the Report, which seeks to speak to what the Bill seeks to do, the last paragraph says:

“The Bill, therefore, seeks to provide access to financial support and resources for the provision of specialist healthcare services to totally reduce the alarming rate of death associated with chronic diseases and NCDs”.

7.02 p.m.

This particular provision here does not communicate any real need of urgency based upon which this Bill has to be passed.

Mr Speaker, it is for good reason that, under Article 106 of our Constitution, Bills that come before

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this House ordinarily have to go through certain processes: the First Reading, Second Reading, and Third Reading. The relevance of it, if you take Article 106(4) of the Constitution, it says:

“Whenever a bill is read the first time in Parliament, it shall be referred to the appropriate committee appointed under article 103 of this Constitution which shall examine the bill in detail and make all such inquiries in relation to it as the Committee considers expedient or necessary”.

So, the framers of this Constitution believe that when a Bill is introduced, the rationale and the purpose is to allow the Committees to do detailed justice to the provisions of the Bill, so that it serves its intended purpose. The practice of this Bill coming to this House under a certificate of urgency would deny the Committee and this House the benefit of scrutinising in detail and expanding its scope of consultation to ensure that we get the best out of the Bill.

Mr Speaker, the document spoke about stakeholder engagement. They indicated, at the Committee level, that they did some stakeholder engagement, but we are in this House where Bills have come under a certificate of urgency and we had to go back and do further consultation because the scope of the so-called consultation was not adequate. I believe that the nature of this Bill is very critical for us, as a people, so

under a certificate of urgency, it would defeat the purpose for which this Bill that is coming to this House ought to be scrutinised. I agree that it is a matter of importance, but I disagree that this Bill be passed under a certificate of urgency.

Without much said, Mr Speaker, I want to go to 4.2 which is support for Healthcare Financing’ and states:

“This Bill offers a timely solution of providing an alternative source of funding to support the healthcare needs of citizens”.

The provision here which seeks to provide 20 per cent of National Health Insurance Fund (NHIF) to support this particular Bill is very serious to the institution of the NHIS because if you go into this Bill where it is seeking to take 20 per cent of contributions into the NHIF to support this project; then what happens to all the other things that have been burdened on the NHIF? So, I believe that a lot more has to be used, reviewed and be scrutinised by this House, so that we do not do one step and then come back and review it.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I believe that this House should be given the opportunity to take time and go through the regular process in passing this Bill. I so submit, Mr Speaker.

Minister for Education (Mr Haruna Iddrisu): Mr Speaker, I rise

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to speak to the adoption of the Report to consider the urgency of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025 and urge Colleagues to support it, not only relying on the Committee's Report, in particular paragraphs 3.1, 3.2 and 3.3.

Mr Speaker, we are told Parliament will be rising very soon and the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025, popularly and affectionately referred to as a MahamaCares, beyond President Mahama, will still be an institutional bureaucracy that will support persons who have chronic diseases who are in want of support and we are told that chronic diseases account for 45 per cent.

But, Mr Speaker, I am particularly interested in responding positively to two issues raised by the Hon Boamah-Nyarko. Now, for those of us who are learners, why are we asking that this Bill be taken through a certificate of urgency? And to borrow from you, Article 106 provides that every Bill introduced into this House must be *gazetted* for, at least, 14 days. The essence of the 14-day *Gazette*, and that is where I agree with him, is to allow for other persons, including experts, stakeholders, those likely to be affected by the Bill to input into improving the Bill, so that when Parliament is exercising its legislative authority, we are also guided by the public interest.

But, Mr Speaker, the same 106(13) provides for what the Committee has done. It says that where a Committee of Parliament determines the urgency

of the matter, Parliament can exempt the Bill from going through it. That is the essence and I want the Hon Member to pay attention to the words in Article 106(13). It reads:

“Where it is determined by a committee of Parliament appointed for that purpose that a particular bill is of an urgent nature, the provisions of the preceding clauses of this article, other than clause (1) ...”

So, we go back to clause 1, so that we say that do not *gazette* it. It should not go through the necessary mandatory 14-day' notice. This is all we are seeking to do, so that we can pass it into law.

Then, the other reason is that, Mr Speaker, I have seen them debate the policy principles, which I believe will come shortly at Second Reading. So, whether the financing provided—And again, I am just responding to him, Mr Speaker, and I conclude.

It is a brilliant point he made: the NHIA, but in this House and let it be stated, the NHIA, in the last eight years, spent huge amounts of money on IT infrastructure. That is not justified on both Sides of the House. Every year, they get US\$1 billion or US\$2 billion. Where in the world do they build IT infrastructure and every year they spend the same amount on that infrastructure? I have had the privilege to be Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations. When you build a system, you build a system.

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Mr Speaker, yes, for the 20 per cent, I thought his argument would be how would that affects the functionality of the NHIA? But Mr Speaker, this is a matter that we would deal with at the Second Reading. But I think that, for those of us who are learning, we are only asking for exemption of this Bill from being *gazetted* for 14 days, pursuant to Article 106(13) of the Constitution.

I so submit.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this is not the actual—So, I will take one.

Nana Agyei Baffour Awuah (NPP — Manhyia South): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for indulging me.

Mr Speaker, after listening to the distinguished Hon Haruna Iddrisu, I have no doubt in my mind that this is not something that should be determined under a certificate of urgency and I will explain to you why.

Mr Speaker, he has highlighted all the problems associated with the NHIA and we are going to establish another Fund that comes with bureaucracy. Mr Speaker, it is not as though we do not have a health insurance fund.

7.12 p.m.

Mr Speaker, in fact, when you look at the National Health Insurance Authority Act, 2012, the purpose or

object of it is provided as follows, if I may take the liberty to read:

“An ACT to establish a National Health Insurance Authority to implement a national health insurance scheme, establish a national health insurance fund, to pay for the cost of health care services to members of the scheme, establish a private health insurance scheme, and to provide for related matters.”

So, Mr Speaker, the National Health Insurance Act already exists. If they think they want to introduce a new health fund, in my humble view, it is not urgent. It calls for the need to interrogate it and to ascertain whether there is a need for another fund. Mr Speaker, there is no need—*[Interruption]*—Mr Speaker, I always have a backing vocalist.

Mr Speaker, there is no need for us to rush this. We need to take our time to determine whether or not we are creating a duplicitous institution that will end up being the same thing. We need to be careful, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I think your discussion will come when we are discussing the main—

Mr Baffour Awuah: Mr Speaker, no. The urgency of it. Hon Haruna Iddrisu stated that the detailed scrutiny of the Bill enables experts to contribute to it and that the work of the Committee, creates an exemption

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for that. We are saying that, in this particular case, that exemption that will enable us or give us the room to consider it under a certificate of urgency, should not be allowed because we need the contribution of experts on this. We need it. We cannot rush this.

Mr Speaker, the non-communicable diseases can be added to the NHIA; why the rush? Where is the urgency? That is even quicker. We can add it to it, so why the rush?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Let me give the opportunity to the Deputy Minister-designate. Yes, Hon Grace, let us hear you.

Prof Grace Ayensu-Danquah (NDC — Essikadu-Ketan): Mr Speaker, thank you for allowing me to make a comment on this topic.

Mr Speaker, I agree with Hon Haruna Iddrisu that the urgency of this Bill is not actually in the text of the Bill. The urgency of this Bill is in the implication of the Bill. Mr Speaker, 43 per cent of all mortalities in Ghana are due to non-communicable diseases and when we say non-communicable diseases, it is more about the complications of the non-communicable disease. This is a national crisis.

As we speak today, Mr Speaker, we see people on television asking for funding because now they have

cancer and the health insurance is not enough. We see people on television who have diabetes, who have now been amputated, and they do not have enough money to take care of the complications of the diabetes. We see people with high blood pressure who have now developed end-stage kidney disease and need to be on dialysis, but they do not have enough. So, what we see are people soliciting funds to take care of complications of non-communicable diseases.

So, Mr Speaker, I think that this Bill is urgent. It is exceedingly urgent. Ghanaians are waiting for it. Ghanaians are dying, as we speak today, in the hospitals because this Bill has not been passed. People are still soliciting on television today. People are being maimed today. People are laying on dialysis machines today. People are being amputated today. People are going through cancer treatment and they do not have enough money to take care of the chemotherapy as well as the radiation therapy.

Mr Speaker, this Bill is urgent. Ghanaians are waiting for it. Ghanaians need it. Our people are suffering and this Bill, titled MahamaCares, is the game-changer that we need to solve the chronic health problems in this country.

I thank you, Mr Speaker. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let me now come to Leadership.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, our leadership would yield to Hon Anyimadu-Antwi.

Mr Kwame Anyimadu-Antwi (NPP — Asante Akim Central): Mr Speaker, I will not speak on this for a long time, but I will urge the Hon Minister. I have read through the Report and save that the Committee says that this Bill must be taken under a certificate of urgency, I did not see any reasons. Please, Hon Minister, listen to me very well.

All that has been said is that this Bill is a very important Bill for the nation, but we must draw the line between what is important and what is urgent. Looking through the Bill, I realised that the amount that is being given, the only solid source of funding is part of the health insurance, which is 20 per cent of that. We are yet to consider that. Now, I would urge upon the Hon Minister to consult further.

Now, if we look at the fund, they are saying that they would use this 20 per cent money to pay for the expenses of the fund, inclusive of salaries. They are collapsing it already. So, I urge him; because of their numbers, they may go ahead for us and I know that this is something that had come up, and it is even known as MahamaCares.

Mr Speaker, no President would not want to push his legacy. By all means, this Bill will see the light of day, but I urge that we do it well.

There is a lot that we can—This Bill, we can finish it today, but at the end of the day, there will be problems. There is nothing urgent. So, I urge the Minister—Because we have about two weeks to rise, I was thinking that under normal circumstances, this Bill will go through the processes and even on vacation, we can enrich this Bill for the betterment of the entire nation.

So, I pray thee, Hon Minister, it is your Bill and I urge you that if you do not mind, you should let this Bill go through the normal processes because I do not see anything urgent about this, but I say it is an important Bill.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leadership?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, one, it is most inaccurate to suggest that no cogent reasons have been canvassed to take this Bill under a certificate of urgency. It is most inaccurate. The Report, in paragraphs 3(1)(2)(3) and (4)—And 3(4)(i) and (ii) indicates clearly the grounds upon which this Bill is being urged upon Parliament to be taken with alacrity.

7.22 p.m.

The Chairman and now Ranking Member for Constitutional and Legal Affairs to make those suppositions that the Report does not convey those reasons, is unfortunate. But the Report will bear the House out that the Committee indeed itemised the

grounds upon which they made the determination that the Bill be taken under a certificate of urgency.

Mr Speaker, Members have made their points regarding why the Bill needs to be taken expressly, so with these words, having clarified that the Report contains good reasons, for which we have to take it through a certificate of urgency, I urge the House to adopt the Report so we can make progress. I thank you for the opportunity.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I pray that we take Motion numbered 4, on the Order Paper *Addendum*.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, the Chairman of the Committee.

BILL — SECOND READING

Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025

Mr Mohammed Ramadan Adamu on behalf of the Chairman (Mr Mark Kurt Nawaane): Mr Speaker, I beg to move the Motion that the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time. Mr Speaker, in doing so, I would urge the *Hansard* to capture everything as though the Report had been read.

Introduction

The Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025 was laid in Parliament on

Monday, 21st July, 2025 by the Hon Minister for Health, Mr Kwabena Mintah Akandoh, in accordance with article 106(1) of the 1992 Constitution.

Pursuant to article 106(4) of the 1992 Constitution and the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Speaker subsequently referred the Bill to the Committee on Health for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee met with the Hon Minister for Health and Officials of the Ministry of Health on Monday, 21st July, 2025 to consider the Bill. In attendance at the meeting were key officials of Departments and Agencies of the Ministry. The Committee was assisted in its deliberations by officials of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice.

The Committee expresses profound gratitude to the Hon Minister and other stakeholders for attending upon it, and providing assistance during its deliberations.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during the deliberations:

- i. The Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992; The Standing Orders of Parliament;
- ii. The National Health Insurance Act, 2012 (Act 852) as

amended by the National Health Insurance (Amendment) Act, 2015 (Act 888);

- iii. The Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843); and
- iv. The Interpretation Act, 2009 (Act 792).

Background

The Government of Ghana, as part of efforts to bridge existing gaps in healthcare financing, seeks to introduce an initiative for treatment of chronic and non-communicable diseases by providing financial support to afflicted individuals through the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. In alignment with the Universal Health Coverage Roadmap of Ghana and other national health policies, the initiative seeks to strengthen healthcare financing mechanisms, thereby reducing the incidence of financial constraints as a bar to quality specialist care.

The Government recognises that concentration of specialist medical services in urban centres, inadequate diagnostic equipment, insufficient data management systems and high cost of treatment impede access to specialist care by patients suffering from chronic ailments including cardiovascular diseases, cancer and renal failure.

Accordingly, proceeds of the Fund would cater to the high-cost of

specialist treatment for chronic and life-threatening illnesses that are not fully covered by the National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS); support medical infrastructure investment through acquisition of vital medical equipment; facilitate specialist training and medical research; and establish a national digital registry to ensure effective implementation of approved eligibility criteria and transparency in the management of claims.

The Fund would be established as a statutory trust governed by a Board of Trustees, who would oversee administration of the estimated annual cost of Three Billion Ghana Cedis to be drawn from financing sources including allocations from the National Health Insurance Fund, government budgetary provisions, corporate donations and philanthropic support.

The Bill, therefore, seeks to provide a legislative framework for the Ghana Medical Trust Fund and set out arrangements for the management of the Fund.

Purpose of the Bill

The Bill seeks to establish the Ghana Medical Trust Fund to mobilise resources to finance and provide specialised medical care for persons with chronic diseases, within a well-structured framework that would ensure equitable distribution of public funds. **Summary of Provisions of the Bill**

The Bill contains a total of 47 clauses.

Clauses 1 to 5 of the Bill set out the legal and operational basis for the Ghana Medical Trust Fund.

Clauses 6 to 13 of the Bill establish the governance structure of the Fund, which includes a thirteen-member Board of Trustees as the governing body of the Fund.

Clauses 14 to 20 provide for the administration of the Fund, including the establishment of a secretariat headquartered in Accra, and the appointment of the Administrator of the Fund and other staff.

Clauses 21 to 24 deal with financial provisions including expenses of the Fund and exemptions from the payment of taxes.

Clauses 25 to 32 relate to provisions for beneficiaries and services under the Fund, which include eligibility criteria, application procedure and quality assurance requirements.

Clauses 33 to 36 deal with payment of claims to service providers, and includes the period for vetting of claims and circumstances under which a claim could be rejected.

Clauses 37 to 41 provide for Third-Party Administrators that may be appointed by the Board of Trustees to perform functions on behalf of the Fund.

Clauses 42 and 43 relate to redress mechanisms applicable under the Bill.

Clauses 44 to 46 cover miscellaneous provisions, including data privacy and security requirements.

Clause 47 provides for a consequential amendment of section 42 of the National Health Insurance Act, 2012 (Act 852), in respect of allocations to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund.

Observations

The Committee made the following observations during the deliberations:

Policy Harmonisation

The Committee observed that the introduction of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025 is properly aligned to Ghana's Universal Health Coverage Roadmap and health related strategies of the country, given its envisaged role of filling financing gaps under the National Health Insurance Scheme. Accordingly, the establishment of the Fund conforms with the policy direction of the Ministry of Health, which include plans for full operationalisation of the Free Primary Healthcare policy that is premised on preventive and promotive healthcare strategies. Effective coordination of health-related policies is, therefore, crucial to ensure delivery of holistic healthcare services to Ghanaians without duplicating the roles of already existing institutions in the sector.

Sources of Funding

The Committee deliberated extensively on the sources of moneys for the Fund, particularly having regard to the provisions of clause 3(a) of the Bill which provides that “*The sources of money for the Fund are (a) twenty per cent of total moneys allocated to the National Health Insurance Fund*”. The Committee considered options including a downward revision of the percentage of the National Health Insurance Fund (NHIF) that would be allocated to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, or the provision of a range between 10 to 15 per cent of the NHIF to provide room for some discretion in annual allocations to the Trust Fund.

The Hon Minister for Health indicated that the corresponding amount had already been ring-fenced in the Formula for Disbursement of the National Health Insurance Fund, 2025. Allocation of the funds, according to the Hon Minister, could not be considered in the same light as capping the National Health Insurance Fund, as was the case previously. The funds, in this instance, would be invested in the health sector in another capacity that is beneficial to patients with chronic diseases, in particular, and healthcare delivery generally.

The Minority Members of the Committee were, however, of the view that an allocation of 20 per cent of the NHIF to the Trust Fund would

adversely affect the administration of the NHIF, and would be detrimental to the effective functioning of the Scheme. They were therefore not in support of the 20 per cent allocation from the NHIF to the Trust Fund.

The Committee recommended further engagement with the Ministry of Finance to explore other sources of funding for the Trust Fund, including dedicating portions of the COVID-19 Levy to the Fund. Additionally, proceeds from “sin taxes” could be directed to the Fund, particularly as the use of products levied in this category may, in some instances, be linked to causes of chronic diseases.

Stakeholder Consultations on the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Initiative

The Hon Minister informed the Committee that a Technical Taskforce was constituted to facilitate the operationalisation of the Medical Trust Fund initiative. The Taskforce comprised academics and practitioners in health-related fields, as well as a representative of the Attorney-General’s Department. The Committee was apprised of the extensive stakeholder engagements undertaken by the Taskforce prior to the formulation of the Bill. Representatives of Civil Society Organisations, health related associations and other stakeholders made inputs into the Bill. The Taskforce also undertook a survey to solicit information from the general public for inclusion in the Bill.

National Classification of Data on Diseases

The Committee advocated strongly for the institutionalisation of systems for national classification of data on diseases to facilitate, among others, the formulation of an objective criteria to measure development stages and prevalence of ailments, including non-communicable and chronic diseases. Information derived from the classification would reduce arbitrariness in assessing the condition of patients of chronic diseases, who are eligible for referral to the Trust Fund for support. The Committee recommended, therefore, that a classification of chronic diseases be included in Regulations to the law after its enactment.

Streamline Administrative Processes

The Committee cautioned against creating a Fund over burdened by cost associated with administrative and non-core functions, in order to safeguard patient-centred outcomes and prevent diversion of resources away from patient care. It recommended, therefore, that the Fund be managed by a streamlined secretariat and governed by a transparent financial framework to minimise operational overheads. The Committee accordingly commended provisions under clause 37 of the Bill, which empowers the Board of Trustees to appoint Third Party Administrators to perform functions of the Fund. This arrangement expands administrative capacity of

the Secretariat of the Fund without increasing associated cost.

Creation of Centralised System for Credentialing and Enlisting Service Providers for the NHIS and Trust Fund

In order to streamline data collection and certification of service providers of the NHIS and the Trust Fund, the Committee recommends that the Health Facilities and Regulation Agency (HeFRA) creates a central credentialing and enlisting system. The establishment of a unified digital platform would facilitate the formulation of standardised criteria, and improve access to cost-effective administrative procedures for on-boarding service providers and claims management.

Conclusion

The Committee acknowledges the high mortality rate of patients with chronic diseases in Ghana in view of the high cost of treatment, limited resources for management of such ailments, as well as inadequate specialists in relevant medical fields. It is necessary, therefore, that measures are instituted to address the gaps in financing specialist medical services and improve access to healthcare delivery irrespective of the nature of a person's medical condition.

Having carefully examined the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025, the Committee recommends to the House to adopt this Report and pass

the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025 in accordance with Article 106 (1) of the 1992 Constitution.

Respectfully submitted.

Mr Speaker, the Committee considered the Bill, and made the following observations.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Chairman, hold on.

Mr Habib: Mr Speaker, we do not have the Report the Chairman is presenting.

Mr Speaker, it is clear that the Chairman is not reading from his console. So how is he expecting us to read from our consoles? Is the Chairman reading from the console? The one presenting the report, is he reading from the console? He is not.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, my Brothers, raised an issue, so let us address the matter. Mr Speaker, the Table Office is in charge of the distribution of sufficient copies and they brought enough copies to us and sent sufficient copies to the other Side and proceeded further to upload into everybody's console. So, Hon Anyimadu-Antwi has the Report right in front of his console. Mr Speaker, let us make some progress.

Ranking Member of the Committee (Nana Ayew Afriyie): Mr Speaker, in supporting this Motion and deliberating on the Report, there is a point of difference as far as the work we did on the Ghana Medical

Trust Bill, 2025 was concerned. The Report captured:

“The Minority Members of the Committee were, however, of the view that an allocation of 20 per cent of the NHIF to the Trust Fund would adversely affect the administration of the NHIF, and would be detrimental to the effective functioning of the Scheme. They were therefore not in support of the 20 per cent allocation from the NHIF to the Trust Fund.

The Committee recommended further engagement with the Ministry of Finance to explore other sources of funding for the Trust Fund, including dedicating portions of the COVID-19 Levy to the Fund

Mr Speaker, fundamentally, at variance with the establishment of this Trust, is the need for us to further understand the objective and the gap the Trust seeks to fill. In Act 852(3)(f), the NHIA is supposed to ensure equity in health coverage. The NHIA is supposed to ensure access by the poor to healthcare services. The NHIA is supposed to ensure protection of the poor and vulnerable against financial risk.

7.32 p.m.

Mr Speaker, this is Act 852, establishing the NHIA. Mr Speaker, we definitely have to throw some more light on this Trust regarding the

gap it is filling because the NHIA is already operating. It adds on diseases each year, so there must be clarity on the space the Trust will occupy. It appears it is going to compete with the NHIA. It appears it is going to weaken the NHIA because we are going to take funds from the NHIA; 20 per cent.

Mr Speaker, it appears the poor will be under attack because people are worried about co-payment and taking 20 per cent is like capping 20 per cent. So Mr Speaker, in the previous years, we would see that whenever we met here, under the previous government, there was one common thing between the NPP and my Friends on the other Side; it was on capitation, capping. Both Sides were allergic to capping. The previous government capped 15 per cent, but this is disguised capping of about 20 per cent. Taking 20 per cent of the NHIA funding is a disguised capping. In fact, it is a permanent capping coming this way. So, in one breath, they are decapping it and in the other breath, they are capping it by this way, and then establishing a Trust which is going to compete with the NHIA and weaken it.

Mr Speaker, I think the poor and the most vulnerable will be at risk, contrary to the provision in the Act 852, establishing the NHIA. I think they will be at risk. Therefore, the Hon Minister would have to rethink the establishment of the Trust. I do not know the alias. Mr Speaker, with a Trust that has an alias like this, acceptability will even be a problem.
[Laughter]

Mr Speaker, apart from acceptability, sustainability will be a problem. Take a cue from the Obamacare in the U.S. It is currently *yaamutu*. We would then have to go back to the establishment of the NHIA and call it a Kufuor Trust. That would be extremely dangerous. But it was in the accompanying policy. The Explanatory Memorandum of all had the “Establishment of a Trust” and gave an alias. Mr Speaker, if not for the National Democratic Congress (NDC)-2 or John Mahama-2, I did not know we would have to bring an Explanatory Memorandum for the establishment of a Trust that belongs to a country and say “alias”. So, it is more of a political decision than an economic decision.

Mr Speaker, any decision that one takes politically does not stand the test of time. It does not. We in the Minority, will help the Majority to work. But it is for us to challenge and interrogate them with more arguments. So, we are only asking them to deepen their argument. We are not checkmating them to stop because they also have to execute their manifesto. In fact, in the manifesto, there are a lot of promises in there, Mr Speaker. We do not have to checkmate them. This year should be for them. So, that from next year, we would start ticking what is their manifesto and what has been done. So, we do not stand to actually checkmate them; they have to execute it. But we want to actually see to it that the implementation comes *ex ante* evaluation, so that there will be

less problem. So that ex post, it is going to be very sustainable. My lawyer is here on the other Side. When she is there, I am comfortable to argue. It stands to reason.

Mr Speaker, this Trust will compete with the NHIA. Currently, the tariff or the rate to providers are not encouraging. I thought when the President was uncapping, he was going to let doctors and providers smile because NHIA by practice, by literature—Health insurance is not to impoverish. Mr Speaker, I did extensive work on NHIA when I was a student at the University of Leeds and it was clear that in areas that we have NHIA, it makes healthcare actually thrive and make people smile. So, when the President uncapped it, we thought they were actually correcting what we did not do. We did something wrong in the previous government; that was capping them. I stood here and I argued against it. It was not changed. So, when they uncapped it, I congratulated them, and I will always congratulate them. But actually, going to give it to a Trust is more of robbing Peter to pay Paul.

And also, they have the same thing. This Trust is going to have a tariff committee. They will set their tariff; they will have their diseases. At point in time, we would have to refer cases from a hospital to them, and there is going to be confusion. It is more of setting up a job for the boys. But we will allow them to have it to set jobs for the boys; no problem.

Mr Speaker, there is nothing wrong with the initiative, but I thought during the stakeholder consultation, they would have included us. Because during the budget, unlike the economic dialogue forum that we boycotted, in my submission, I said when they are going for the consultation on this, we are ready to join them. Mr Speaker, we had no invite. But the point is, over here, I thought a Trust in a vacuum was going to, among others, take care of the gaps in the health system. The Global Alliance for Vaccines and Immunization (GAVI), which is one of the reasons we have to do this under urgency—The Minister is going for a GAVI Board Meeting; he did not state it. They finance immunisation in this country, and that is going to give us some funds. That is why for me, I think we should have taken this on urgency, and I do not regret it, because his attendance is going to help the country a lot. The inability to do this tomorrow is not going to help us, because his presence is going to justify some increase in allocation to us, of which he must be able to attend the board meeting. Therefore, trying to work on this on urgency tomorrow is actually alright, because we know what is ahead of him.

Mr Speaker, nonetheless, we have to be careful of this Trust. There is an immunisation sustainability issue ahead of the country. After five years, GAVI is not supporting us again. So, a Trust that will look into the future, making funds available to sustain us,

was going to be welcomed if they had invited us to make our point.

Mr Speaker, we talked about health infrastructure. Inasmuch as they said they will repeal the COVID-19, we will stand by them the day they will say sorry, provided they are going to use it to complete the many health infrastructures that will grant easy access to universal health care. And we would have stated it there, but we were not part of it. Mr Speaker, if indeed they had invited us to the dialogue session, we would have told them, just like we agreed yesterday when we were making this Bill, to add some specialty training. Not only that, they should be interested in the institutionalisation or the creation of more specialty hospitals, which is good for us. And that is one thing that the Trust absorbed. So, the Minority continued with them because we shared a common point with them when they told us they were going to establish subspecialty hospitals and even support their training. We thought that was brilliant; it was filling the gap. So, in effect, there are part of the Trust we must have to associate with.

7.42 p.m.

But there are some parts of the Trust that is going to compete with the already existing one and that is a problem for all of us.

Mr Speaker, again there is health security; pandemics can hit us any time. So, a Trust looks into the future

of how we are secured in terms of our security on pandemics, take it or leave it. Mr Speaker, a Trust could have been interested in supplying medical equipment to hospitals because a lot of hospitals have its equipment, *yaamutu*, collapsed. So, a Trust will have a vacuum to fill and we were ready to go and dialogue with them, but we were not part of it. Nonetheless, the Trust they have brought is defining a competing objective with the already existing one and that is why I am worried about the sustainability and *alias* of this Trust.

So, Mr Speaker, I am done with my submission, but if they will have a reason to even withdraw the Motion that accompanied the Bill that was brought here, so that we have a good ability to dialogue on both Sides to understand the Trust without bringing the competing trust for the NHIA; it will even be better.

I thank you so much for the time.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, we have agreed among ourselves that we will do five on each Side.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
No—

Mr Acheampong: I proposed three and the Hon Deputy Minority Whip said we should do five from each Side and I am going with his proposal, so what is his point again? Mr Speaker, we are talking about health. It is past 7 o'clock, so talking

into the night is not good for our health. Mr Speaker, we can moderate it and do four minutes, so that we can accommodate five on each Side, making 10 and the Minister will conclude. Overstaying is not good for our health. We will do the rest tomorrow. We are taking the Report today, so we are doing five on each Side.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members—

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not know who my Hon good Friend, Mr Acheampong, agreed with. If they think that we are going to rush this, we would not; it is important. The fact that he said Deputy Minister of Health talked about health-related issue—Mr Speaker, give us opportunity to talk about it. We are not capping it at five. Many on my Side want to contribute to it, so allow them to contribute. He cannot cap it.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion has been moved and seconded. The Motion is now before the House for consideration. Yes, Hon Deputy Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs.

Deputy Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs (Ms Rita Naa Odoley Sowah): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the Report on the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025,

popularly known as MahamaCares. Mr Speaker, this is an initiative being introduced to bridge existing gaps in healthcare financing for the treatment of—

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, if the Deputy Minister wants to debate on the Motion before us and the Report, there is nothing like MahamaCares on the Report, so she cannot say, “popularly known as”. Who is calling it that? Mr Speaker, this is a House of records. When they passed the Energy Sector Levy Act and we call it the *Dumsor* Levy, they said there was nothing like that in the Report. So, there is nothing like that in this Report.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

I am inclined to go with the First Deputy Minority Whip. There is nothing indicating anything like MahamaCares. Let us pass our Bill; When the Bill gets out and we designate it as such, that is another thing. But on records, there is nothing like that. Is that not the case?

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, the Committee Members can attest to this. If you check the third paragraph of the Memorandum, with your indulgence, Mr Speaker, let me read:

“In view of the above, Ghana seeks to introduce the Ghana Medical Trust Fund also known as MahamaCares Initiative...”

The Memorandum gives as the background, so the Report is birthed from the Memorandum that we are holding; it is here and the Ranking Member even mentioned it and we were here; we heard him right. They can go and bring BawumiaCares, we do not mind. It is in the Memorandum.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Acheampong, does the Report capture it like that?

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, the Report is silent on the “MahamaCares”.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, please—

Mr Acheampong: But Mr Speaker, you know that a Report can never capture everything on the Memorandum. No report does that.

Dr Afriye: My Friend on the other Side mentioned me as the Ranking Member. It is me; I am the Ranking Member.

Mr Speaker, the Motion on the Floor—I beg you, the item numbered 4, Motion, at page 2 of the Order Paper *Addendum*—This is a House of records and we are talking about “That Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time.”

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, *finito*.

Please, Hon Members, the Bill before us is the Ghana Medical Trust

Fund, 2025. Please, let us deal with the Bill.

Yes, Hon Deputy Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs?

Ms Sowah: Mr Speaker, this is an initiative to bridge the existing gaps between financing for treatment of communicable, non-communicable and chronic diseases.

Mr Speaker, H. E. John Dramani Mahama deems it fit that he introduces this social intervention programme to support people who are suffering from these diseases. Mr Speaker, mostly it is women who suffer more with breast cancer, cervical cancer among others, so, as a father for the nation, he deems it fit to support us, a caring father that H. E. John Dramani Mahama is—*[Hear! Hear!]*—So, his Government has brought up this initiative.

I heard some of my Hon Colleagues say that it should be passed through the National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS). Mr Speaker, NHIS takes care of basic diseases, but then the Ghana Medical Trust Fund is going to take care of these chronic and non-communicable diseases. There is the need for us to ensure that we pass this Bill into law, so that our brothers and sisters who are suffering from such illnesses will be saved.

Mr Speaker, as Members of Parliament, as we sit here in this

Chamber, most of our constituents come to us with these diseases for us to support them. Recently, somebody came to me; he has to pay GHC500.00 a week. For the month, it will be GHC2,000.00 and they cannot afford it. But I believe when this Bill is passed, they will have some freedom to ensure that their diseases will be taken care of.

Mr Speaker, some people lose their lives due to lack of money; they cannot pay for their dialysis and all that and records have it that 43 per cent of deaths come from these non-communicable diseases. Mr Speaker, we cannot describe the frustrations that people go through. Sometimes, through the frustrations, knowing that they cannot afford the dialysis and all that, they even die before their time.

7.52 p.m.

I think we can avoid such deaths by passing this Bill to ensure that our people live a healthy life.

When we talk about the sources of funding, Mr Speaker, I would want to add that the 1 per cent COVID-19 Levy should be redirected to this Fund, among other Funds, to support the funding of these diseases.

Mr Speaker, His Excellency John Dramani Mahama, a father of the nation, who has the people at heart, through the Ministry of Health and through Parliament, wants this Bill passed under this certificate of urgency to ensure that we all lead

healthy lives. Today, it can be somebody; tomorrow, it might be you. Maybe you can afford; others cannot afford. Let us support our brothers and sisters in this nation.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
Thank you.

Let me go to Takoradi.

Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah (NPP — Takoradi): Mr Speaker, I am very happy that I have been included in this debate.

Mr Speaker, if we take the Report of the Committee, they are very clear that the budget for taking care of non-communicable diseases would amount to about GHC3 billion, but if we also look at the same Report, it talks about taking about 20 per cent of the National Health Insurance Fund to support this agenda. The same Committee was very concerned that the proposers of this Bill are not considerate and therefore, they needed to reduce it from the 20 per cent to about 15 per cent. Clearly, what we are being told is that President John Mahama does not care and why?

Mr Speaker, if we take the Bill, they are very clear in their mind that the cost of administering the Bill is going to be very high. Therefore, they are advising that there need to be caps and they need to be managed. Mr

Speaker, if the system is not broken, why fix it? All the non-communicable diseases that we have talked about gradually, have been taken on by the National Health Insurance, so why create another agency to manage the money? Why create another agency to create new data systems? Then the same Report will tell us that they need to merge these systems.

Clearly, there is something wrong. Either the NDC wants to deceive themselves that they are creating a new social policy, but this is not new. Mr Speaker, this is just not new. All that they needed to do was to just issue a policy paper that we have increased the coverage and have added new diseases to the National Health Insurance list. It is as simple as that. Why take Ghanaians through all these troubles when we need the money to serve the people and pay for the debt or the cost of medicals at that specialised level?

Mr Speaker, I want to say and I want to also emphasise that clearly, we do not need anything called the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. We do not need it. In fact, the cost of administering it could take care of more people under the roll at NHIA, which is an Authority, apart from just being a manager of Funds. This is only going to manage funds.

Mr Speaker, I believe that in the same Report that the Committee has been speaking to, they are telling us that there are dangers ahead of us, that we are going to be spending some

money on the administration of this Bill and this Fund, and we need that to support people. In fact, a lot of people who are suffering from non-communicable diseases need the money to solve their problems, not for the politics. If they want to create a new social policy, they should think of something else. Already, National Health Insurance exists and I believe that that is the way to go, instead of wasting our time on this policy that is going to take money from National Health Insurance and spend on things that we actually do not need.

With these few words, Mr Speaker, I believe that we need to reject this policy and make it clear to Ghanaians that we can use the National Health Insurance policy to solve this problem. We do not need any new bureaucracy. We just need the money for the people to solve their health problems.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for this opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, let me go to the Minister of State, Government Communications.

Mr Felix Kwakye Ofosu (NDC — Abura-Asebu-Kwamankese): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for giving me the opportunity to contribute to this debate.

Mr Speaker, it has been suggested here that creating an entirely new bureaucracy to address this pressing concern we have will amount to

duplication. Mr Speaker, I beg to differ. It is incumbent on every country to have policy flexibility in order to respond to emerging difficulties. The NHIS has been around for two decades or more, and yet, we have been experiencing, in recent times, an explosion in non-communicable diseases cases. The NHIS has proven insufficient to deal with this serious crisis.

Mr Speaker, barely a year ago, the National Dialysis Centre at the Korle-Bu Teaching Hospital had to be closed down because their Government could not find GHC4 million to supply consumables and other essential items to the Dialysis Centre.

Mr Speaker, it has also been suggested that there is no need to take this Bill under a certificate of urgency because we have all the time in the world. I say, there is no greater sense of urgency in our country today than the need to address this explosion in non-communicable diseases which continues to take the lives of even the young.

Mr Speaker, I was broken to learn only last week that a 17-year-old boy had lost his life due to kidney failure. This was a young boy whose life was snuffed out because of a non-communicable disease. Mr Speaker, young men and women in their 30s and 40s are dying prematurely because of the upsurge in non-communicable diseases. What it means is that there has been a certain

policy failure in addressing these rising cases.

So, it is timely and it is opportune that President Mahama has deemed it necessary to establish the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, popularly called MahamaCares. Mr Speaker, note that I have said it is popularly called; I did not say that is what this House calls it. The people of Ghana have the right to call it by any name they want, to the extent that it meets with their aspirations. Of course, we know its official nomenclature: it is the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, but the urgency of this situation cannot be overemphasised.

Mr Speaker, this Bill should have been passed yesterday, so that the many lives that we are losing on a daily basis are curtailed. So, that our young people can look up to live long, healthy, meaningful lives and not have their lives snapped out in their prime. Mr Speaker, I think that we need to put politics aside. This Bill poses no threat to the National Health Insurance Scheme.

Indeed, I heard my respected Colleague, Hon Dr Ayew Afriye, say that taking 20 per cent of the National Health Insurance Scheme would cripple it. Mr Speaker, they capped the National Health Insurance Scheme and funnelled the proceeds thereof into general expenditure. We are taking 20 per cent of the amount accruing to the National Health Insurance Scheme to put into this most important Fund that will serve a

vital and essential function. I see no reason for which anybody who is committed to improving the health care needs of our people would see any difficulty with this arrangement.

8.02 p.m.

Mr Speaker, contrary to the parlous states in which the National Health Insurance Scheme found itself, today it is buoyant. Close to GH¢10 billion will be accruing to the National Health Insurance Fund this year. Mr Speaker, only last week, the Minister for Health disclosed that all arrears stemming from 2024 have been cleared. Mr Speaker, now allocations of GH¢603 million have been cleared. There were arrears. Indeed, at no time in the last eight years have there never been arrears.

Mr Speaker, currently, allocations have improved from around 68 per cent to 75 per cent. So, the National Health Insurance Scheme is in good health and does not stand any risk with the emergence of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund. So, I would urge my Colleagues that we do not beat about the bush at a time when our citizens are dying. We cannot waste any further time at a time when our young men and women are losing their lives. We cannot double in politics at a time when we are heading towards an explosion in non-communicable diseases. Let us band together and do what is right by our people and what is right is setting up this fund, financing it with reliable proceeds from the National Health

Insurance Levy and the other sources that the Minister has outlined in the Bill, and ensuring that it is properly managed, that there are sustainable structures built in, and that access is equitable, it is fair and non-discriminatory. Only then and then, Mr Speaker, can we say that when history called on us as a Ninth Parliament to ensure that we curtail the needlessness of our young people and perhaps our older generation, we rose to the occasion.

I thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

[Hear! Hear!]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let me give way to the Hon Member for Offinso North who is in the medical profession. Yes, Dr Fred Asamoah?

Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah (NPP — Offinso North): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, I am the last person to oppose when there is an opportunity to support healthcare in this country because in my Constituency, Offinso North, we do have people that, most of the time, need help.

Mr Speaker, we all agree per the agency's report that is saying that 45 per cent of death in this country is as a result of NCDs. But the question one will ask is how many of these 45 per cent go into critical care that requires this bridging fund. This fund, Mr Speaker, is basically a bridging fund. That is to help those that are not being covered by the NHIS.

Mr Speaker, one question that we have to advert our minds to is how did we arrive at the 20 per cent of the NHIS? Already the NHIS is challenged but the question one will want to ask, how did we arrive at the 20 per cent of the NHIS? What is the actuarial data that is informing this decision? Mr Speaker, the question would be, if the NHIS revenue goes down, that means the amount or the fund that will be required to support this fund would go down. In that same vein, if the fund goes up, then the amount is going to go up. The question is that if this Parliament believes that NHIS needs 10 billion, why would we then stop and go and take 2 billion out of that money to go and support a bridging fund? Different countries have tried this bridging fund and we do remember when we were debating the Budget, I made the Statement that this is another way of getting things disappear in this country. As to how the interpretation will be taken, Mr Speaker, is some question that we all have to answer.

If we are talking about renal disease and we say that people have to be on dialysis, we need to be able to have some data informing the prevalent rate that can guide the amount of money that one will need to be able to support this bridging fund. So, we need to find out how much we need to support this fund, the envelope that is needed. If not, then sustainability will become a problem.

It looks like it is a knee-jerk reaction. For me, I will support this fund, but we need a proper data analysis to be able to come out with this fund. If not, Mr Speaker, one would have argued that as other countries use Prescribed Minimum Benefits (PMBs), could we not have improved on the NHIS so that this bridging fund can be determined by special committees that will be able to support the care for critical patients?

Mr Speaker, another issue is that apart from the sustainability issue, there could be a governing risk. How much have we been able to take care of NHIS as far as governing issues are concerned? Similar issues were raised by Hon Haruna Iddrisu. So, this is a challenge already with NHIS, and we are bringing another agency on. We need a proper data analysis to be able to determine.

Then, Mr Speaker, we are saying that we want to make critical care available to people across the country, but per the Bill, one of the decisions we are making is that it is only specialists that can refer. Mr Speaker, in our quest to support patients and to save lives, with this bridging fund, what is going to do —because the specialist will have to be the one that will refer you to the fund, it is going to lead to a break in care, because we are saying that a general practitioner cannot refer somebody onto this fund. It has to be a specialist medical practitioner. That means that there is going to be a break in care, and this could lead to more death than we are

trying to save. So, Mr Speaker, let us be careful. We need time to really review, other than that, some of the provisions that we have made, that only a specialist medical practitioner can refer somebody to this fund, and that medical practitioners across the country which are all over cannot do it, it is going to cause more issues.

Mr Speaker, how many specialists do we have in this country? We need to look at this very well. For me, I support this bridging fund, but we need to have some actuarial data to inform it for us to be able to review this.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I want to end.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Let me give it to Hon Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah.

Mr Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah (NDC — Ho West): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I rise to support the Motion, and also add my voice to what we popularly refer to as MahamaCare, the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill.

Mr Speaker, the philosophy and understanding behind this Bill, basically, we all know, is to support diseases that the National Health Insurance will not cover; diseases as we all know in this House as hypertension, cancer, and the rest.

Mr Speaker, there are a couple of us who are suffering from hypertension in this Chamber and I

believe that when this Bill is passed into law, the majority of us would get support from this Medical Trust Fund Bill. Our families are dying. Our brothers and sisters are dying because they do not have money to manage these diseases that we know as chronic diseases.

8.12 p.m.

When this Trust fund comes into being, I believe that those who pass on without any support from the Government or from any establishment will now have support from this Trust Fund. And therefore, I believe that my Colleagues on the other Side will support it, because where the NHIA stops, that is where the Ghana Medical Trust Fund takes up from.

So, we need to support it and make sure that those who are suffering from these diseases like hypertension and those who go to do chemotherapy in the various hospitals will not use their own money again, and they will not use the second tier of their medical insurance. I know some people in this room who are doing dialysis. This Ghana Medical Trust Fund will take care of it. So, the saviour has come, and we all need to applaud it.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, let us help the poor who are dying, so that the MahamaCares can take care of it.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.
[Hear! Hear!]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Anyimadu-Antwi has already spoken; that is why I am overlooking him.

Mr Samuel Abdulai Jinapor (NPP — Damongo): Mr Speaker, I want to thank you for the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, I think it is important for us to establish one very fundamental point, that we from this Side are not opposed to any attempt by the Government to enhance the healthcare delivery system of our country for the good of the Ghanaian people. Mr Speaker, we are not opposed to it in any form or shape.

In any event, it is the NPP Government under President John Agyekum Kufuor, the distinguished statesman, who birthed the National Health Insurance Scheme. Mr Speaker, until then, Ghana did not have a health insurance scheme. It took a nosedive, and President Akufo-Addo revamped it. So, it is important for us to establish a point that the New Patriotic Party, and for that matter, this Side of the House, this Minority, will never take any stand against the Mahama Government and the Hon Minister for Health, in any attempt to enhance healthcare delivery in our country.

Secondly, Mr Speaker, the issue of non-communicable disease is a major one in our country. We all have elderly parents, and we know what parents and the elderly go through when it comes to non-communicable diseases.

Mr Speaker, thirdly, we are all also aware, and this House has had multiple occasions to observe what I am about to say and to debate this matter, the duplication of institutions. Indeed, reputable organisations such as the United Nations (UN), United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), World Health Organization (WHO), and the International Monetary Fund (IMF) have all decried the concept of governments, particularly from third-world countries spending huge sums of money, administrative funds, on duplication of institutions.

Mr Speaker, I need not point out that when President Barack Obama came to our country, he reminded all of us that we should build institutions. We heard from our Friends. They are talking about non-communicable diseases. The question which we have to pose—And I see that the Hon Minister for Health is here. Mr Speaker, why can we not review the National Health Insurance Scheme and the National Health Authority to deal with these non-communicable diseases?

Mr Speaker, is Ghana not tired of government after government duplicating institutions, birthing new institutions, burdening our national health sector on administrative funding, and so on and so forth? Mr Speaker, is Ghana not tired of that? When we take a look at the Report of the Committee, and if I may refer Mr Speaker to page 5, paragraph 7.2., titled “Sources of funding”, I quote:

“...20 per cent of total money is allocated to the National Health Insurance Fund, the Committee considered options, including a downward revision of the percentage of the National Health Insurance Fund that will be allocated to the Ghana Medical Trust Fund.”

Mr Speaker, the source of funding for this fund is from the National Health Insurance Fund. So wherein lies the certificate of urgency, Mr Speaker? Why set up a fund, take money from another health insurance fund, populate this fund—When the Committee itself even says—Mr Speaker, let me even refer us again to page 7. The Committee says:

“It recommended, therefore, that the fund be managed by a streamlined secretariat and governed by a transparent financial framework to minimise operational overheads.”

And then it says:

“The committee recommended further engagement with the Ministry of Finance to explore other sources of funding for the trust fund.”

So, Mr Speaker, we are passing a Bill without any additional source of funding, apart from the 20 per cent from the National Health Insurance Fund.

Mr Speaker, the suggestion is sometimes made that this is a partisan exercise. The question that I believe our Friends should advert their minds to is that we have a Health Insurance Fund; we have a Health Insurance Scheme; and we have a Health Insurance Authority. We are creating a new fund; we are creating a new institution and we are going to burden it with a secretariat and administrative funding. Mr Speaker, there is no additional funding from anywhere. They are taking 20 per cent from the health insurance fund. Why not expand and strengthen the existing institution?

Mr Speaker, I want to conclude by saying that this Bill itself is contradictory in terms. It is very clear. It is a duplication in purpose and function. Mr Speaker, the Bill itself seems to have a chronic disease. It is a non-communicable Bill. Mr Speaker, let them join us. There is no urgency here. There is no emergency here. There is no need for this fund. There is no need to create a new fund. Strengthen the national health insurance fund, which was established by President Kufuor and the New Patriotic Party. Enough of having new administrations, new institutions. Enough is enough, Mr Speaker.

Thank you for your attention.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, can I revert to Leadership? Majority Leader, can I take the Minority?

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, we actually have two more, and they are Members of the Committee.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: They have all spoken. Hon Member, I am tired. Let us revert to Leadership.

Mr Shaib: It is a humble prayer. We have Members of the Committee and we have our senior Members, but it is at your discretion. It is just a humble prayer.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I will take one from each Side. Let me go to Hon Afful.

Dr Eric Afful (NDC — Amenfi West): Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I am going to be as brief as possible. I want to remind our Friends that from 2017 to 2024, the National Health Insurance Fund has been capped between 15 to 20 per cent. We have not seen the use of that capping amount.

8.22 p.m.

That is the reason this Government wants to take that percentage and put it into this Fund. That is the first thing.

Mr Speaker, to be specific on this, Hon Members should check the 2024 Budget Statement and Economic Policy. The Scheme was to have a

revenue of GHC7.9 billion, for which the allocation to the Scheme was GHC6.5 billion after capping. This means that they capped the Scheme of about GHC1.4 billion. Where did we expend this money? Where is this money? That is the reason we want to pick this variation into this Fund. So please, allow us to govern this country.

Mr Speaker thank you for the opportunity. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member for Abuakwa South, please, be brief as your Colleague did.

Dr Kingsley Agyemang (NPP — Abuakwa South): Mr Speaker, I think the sense of the House is very clear. We are all saying the same thing to the effect that one out of two deaths that happens in these countries as a result of a non-communicable diseases. This has created a lot of multi-morbidity that has a negative impact on performance and the general protection of the nation. We are not opposing to any system of financing that will help improve the healthcare of our people. The real thing is that this is about health financing and it is important to have a more rigorous source of financing.

Mr Speaker, I take your leave to read the main objective of the National Health Insurance Act, 2012, particular reference to Section 2:

“The objective of the Fund is to attain universal health insurance coverage in relation to or for the protection of Ghanaians.”

I am not too sure this objective has changed. If this objective has not changed and we want to improve on it and we are bringing up a financing fund or a financing vehicle called insurance, it is important to have an actuarial determinant of what really the issues are. If I ask the Minister now of what the extent of our exposure is when it comes to non-communicable diseases, I am not sure there is a report on that.

Mr Speaker, what we are saying is that we are more confronted with a problem that is so huge; non-communicable diseases are one out of two deaths. However, the financing arrangement to solve this problem is not rigorous enough. Nobody does an insurance provision without an actuarial memorandum. It is not done anywhere. We are only cautioning that if you are taking as huge as 20 per cent from an existing Fund, do we have an actuarial impact assessment on how the Fund will work when we take out this 20 per cent? We are appealing to our Friends to soberly consider a more rigorous and a more extensive financing source. This is like turning a triangle within a circle. The space displayed is the same. How did we even arrive at this variable called 20 per cent from the National Health Insurance Fund? This was arbitrarily done. We are saying that we might have made mistakes in the past, but we cannot continue to make mistakes.

This 20 per cent from the National Health Insurance Fund is going to impact on service provision. They are all alluding to how the problems that the National Health Insurance Authority is going through. But if we are bringing up a Fund that is taking 20 per cent from the primary to finance an objective that is already not well taken care of and the expenditure to this fund is very clear. We are going to create a secretariat, finance compensations and other capital expenditure items from a Fund that is bedevilled with a lot of expenditure.

Mr Speaker, we are appealing to our Colleagues. We have to be more rigorous going forward on some of these sources. If we read the source of funding, they are now going around asking for donations, even from existing staff of the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) to finance a funding arrangement.

Mr Speaker, this cannot be the way to go.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let me now come to Leadership—No, you said you are yielding to—

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: With all due deference, we said one from each Side before Leadership and I am yielding mine—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: All right.

Mr Akwasi Konadu (NPP — Manhyia North): Mr Speaker, thank you very much and let me thank my Leadership for this opportunity to contribute to this Report.

Mr Speaker, I would want my Brothers on the other Side to understand that I am not harmful. Inasmuch as we are allowing them to govern, it is important that we also protect the country. We cannot litigate on our non-opposition to this Trust Fund and we cannot say more about that, but we would want to say this: we are opposed to a Trust Fund that would be in competition with an Authority that is established to look after the healthcare of Ghanaians, first and foremost.

Mr Speaker, why we are opposed to it is that, first and foremost, it has no source of funding and I say no source of funding—Our Brothers on the other Side and the Minister, per the Bill that is in front of us, would use 20 per cent of the National Health Insurance Fund to finance the Trust Fund and the argument for it is this: that between 2017 and 2024, the National Health Insurance Scheme was capped at 15 per cent.

Mr Speaker, the matter of the capping was necessary, but, however, at the point in time, it became important for decapping. If we are decapping at 15 per cent and increasing it to 20 per cent, what, therefore, is the sense and the rationale in you decapping?

Mr Speaker, the reason for the decapping was this: that service providers were not paid on time. Also, one of the main reasons there seemed to have been a challenge with the National Health Insurance and per what the argument is being made, that it could not cater for some of these things were the reasons. Co-financing exists because the drug list and the pricing list for all of these services that are provided is not up to market value and, therefore, service providers out there were of the joy that, once this decapping is coming, it would enhance the flow and the increment in the price list that they were going to have.

Mr Speaker, but we are not going to see that. Our Brothers talked about trying to provide a Fund that will cater for the young men and women in this country and they call this as a new sort of social intervention. What social intervention takes another social intervention in its implementation? They are establishing a Fund that is going to take another insurance to fund that. Are we doing secondary financing or secondary insurance?

Mr Speaker, primary health care is another policy I know they will bring and that would be financed by the National Health Insurance Authority. Primary health care is in the range of trying to promote, prevent, and educate one on lifestyle and also to be able to reduce the incidence of cases that will arise from the primary treatment areas to the secondary and finally to the tertiary where we intend

wanting this Trust Fund to cater for. They are depriving the primary; where lies, therefore, the intent of this Bill. It is only going to increase the incidence of the cases that cannot be catered for to rise to that location.

Mr Speaker, the problem we are having is that they would ask where the capped amount go and it was not used in financing health-related matters. It went into the Consolidated Fund and I would want to say—*[Interruption]*—Leader, let me go ahead because it is important.

Mr Speaker, first and foremost, medical emergencies in this country is not financed by the National Health Insurance Scheme. When I say medical emergencies, COVID-19 was a medical emergency.

8.32p.m.

Mr Speaker, now, we are battling with the Mpox. That is not financed by the Health Insurance, that will be financed by the Central Government. So, if the Central Government caps an insurance policy and puts that in the Consolidated Fund, when medical emergencies happen, we will, therefore, have an alternative to dive into that, so that we do not go punching the Insurance Scheme and Authority that we have. Mr Speaker, you cannot ask me—When COVID struck—

Mr Speaker, last week, we were in the Central Region looking at health

infrastructure and I found out that we had built a new Infectious Disease Centre over there. It was as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic that that foresight was given and that was done. That was not financed by the Health Insurance. It is important.

My Sister here talked about the redirection of the COVID-19 Trust Fund. They know perfectly well that the Trust Fund is not well financed, so even the Fund that they claimed they were going to cancel, now they are also revisiting it the same way that we talked about.

The point we would want to make is that anything that was purposefully done to cater for the health of our Ghanaian citizens, both adults and the young ones, was done during the time of President Kufuor, that is the National Health Insurance which they ran away from. When you talk about it, they will tell you we are not talking about mutual health insurance; we are talking about the National Health Insurance that has already been done. There is no need for us to complicate our problems by trying to build more bureaucracies; it is not of any need.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, let me add my voice to that of the Members of the Committee to urge this House to adopt the Report.

Mr Speaker, from what has been said so far, we all agree that non-

communicable diseases have become a major problem when it comes to healthcare delivery in this country. The statistics are staggering and the thing about these non-communicable diseases is that for most of them, they become a lifelong thing. For the rest of your life, you are living with it. It is chronic and you have to be on medication every single day for the rest of your life; that costs money. Money that many families cannot afford.

The interesting thing is that most of these diseases tend to afflict the elderly in society. People after their 50s and 60s, when they are out of the workforce and they are already suffering from diminished incomes, that is when they are hit with these non-communicable diseases and on a daily basis, their diminished incomes will have to be used to buy medication. Some may not be lucky to have children who can help them with these medications and these diseases often lead to complications. Managing those complications are very expensive. Few are able to afford it and so all of us have a responsibility to figure out how to help people like that.

I do not believe there is a single Member of Parliament in this Chamber who has not been approached by constituents who find themselves in those situations on a daily or weekly basis and we are compelled to use our meagre incomes to support them. It is a fact that many of us in this Chamber are carrying the

burden of managing these diseases by supporting constituents to pay for them. That is why we decided that as a country, we cannot leave these people behind. We need to take care of them and support them. We are thinking about how to finance it.

Of course, I agree that we could also just say that it is one of the diseases that should be taken care of by National Health Insurance Scheme. If we take that approach, it may well be the case that the National Health Insurance will end up spending more than 20 per cent of the money to take care of them. If we take the approach that why can we not just add it as one of the diseases that the National Health Insurance will take care of, we will end up spending more than 20 per cent of the National Health Insurance Scheme money taking care of those cases.

So, we thought about that and we said, we do not want to use all the money in the National Health Insurance Scheme to take care of those cases, but NHIS owes a duty to also make a contribution. It is on that basis that the proposal is that 20 per cent of the NHIA Fund should be dedicated to this trust fund. The rest will come from a number of sources.

One—and I am surprised that we are not paying attention to something innovative that is taking place. For instance, the first thing you have to do is to deal with the price of the medicine. If we are able to put in place a mechanism that ensures that the

price is low, not fair pricing, at least, we would have met the patient somewhere. So, I am even paying more attention to clause 22, which makes provision for exemptions for the importation of those medicines, equipment and for anything that has to do with the management of those diseases. Because when we make provision for tax exemptions, we will have to reduce the prices of those medicines. That for me is even more major than the contribution that we are debating from National Health Insurance.

Clause 22 says that:

- “(a) Subject to Article 174 of the Constitution and the Exemptions Act, the Fund is exempt from the payment of taxes that the Minister responsible for Finance may in writing determine with the prior approval of Parliament.
- (b) the importation of selected medicines, technologies and non-medical consumables recommended by the Board of Trustees through the Minister is exempt from the taxes that the Minister responsible for Finance may in writing determine with the prior approval of Parliament.”

This, for me, is major because it is what will ensure that drugs, medicines, consumables, non-medical consumables and anything that has to do with non-communicable

diseases come into the country and get to the market at very affordable prices. So, for me, this is even more major.

I think that an innovative mechanism is going to be put in place to ensure that the medicines are low in terms of pricing.

8.42 p.m.

Secondly, not to overburden the National Health Insurance Scheme by limiting the contribution of National Health Insurance Scheme to only 20 per cent.

Mr Speaker, even more, we are expecting to convince the public and companies to make donations, and so provision is being made to incentivise companies that make donations. Mr Speaker, so these are innovative mechanisms that will attract funding for us to begin to help the people who are suffering from these non-communicable diseases. I agree with him that its design and the mechanism may have challenges, but let us start from somewhere. Today they are talking about National Health Insurance Scheme. NHIS started somewhere. It started as Mutual Health Insurance, then it migrated into a scheme, and today it is an authority. So please let us start from somewhere.

We did not start the National Health Insurance Authority with the level of sophistication and efficiency and capability that it has today. We

started it as an experiment. I recall that even when President Kufuor announced the implementation, NDC claimed that we were already doing community-financed self-insurance schemes in Techiman and *et cetera*. Then President Kufuor moved it to a Mutual Health Insurance Scheme. In 2012, we then moved it to a National Health Insurance Scheme and then established the Authority.

So yes, let us start from somewhere; there will be challenges. As we move, we will see what opportunities there are to perfect the system. So, I plead with you, let us adopt the Report. Do not be worried about the name being called MahamaCares. Because me too, my name is Mahama, so I care. *[Laughter]*

So, I urge Colleagues that let us adopt this Report and during the Consideration Stage, we can look at the financing mechanisms. If they have any innovative ideas about the financing mechanisms that they want to add, they can bring it, introduce amendments and we can look at it. If it does not offend the Constitution in terms of the provisions relating to legislating financial matters, we can take it on board. But let us allow this to pass. So, I urge Colleagues, to let us adopt the Report and move on to the next stage in the passage of this legislation. I thank you very much. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Members.

Minister, do you want to say something?

Minister for Health (Mr Kwabena Mintah Akandoh): Mr Speaker, I am so grateful for this opportunity. Permit me to also express my sincere gratitude to all Members, especially those who have contributed on the Floor. Let me assure everybody that all observations and concerns have been well noted.

Mr Speaker, let me also state I have heard members say that the Ghana Medical Trust Fund is going to be in competition –

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister — *[Uproar]* Hon Members, we are dealing with the Motion numbered 4 and the Motion numbered 4 is specific.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: The Minister should not call it MahamaCares. On the Motion, it is called Ghana Medical Trust Fund Bill, 2025. Mr Speaker, if they begin to call it MahamaCares, we will begin to call it Mahama Does Not Care. So please, it is not called MahamaCares.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, please restrict yourself.

Mr Akandoh: Mr Speaker, I am guided. Mr Speaker, I have heard some Hon Members say that Ghana Medical Trust Fund is going to compete with the National Health Insurance Scheme. It was clear at the

Committee level, that this particular fund is dedicated towards the treatment of non-communicable diseases (NCDs) that are not captured by the National Health Insurance Authority. Where is the competition? There is absolutely no competition.

We all know, and everybody here, is one way or the other related to somebody battling with this type of chronic disease. I have heard Members say the mortality rate attributable to NCDs is 40 per cent or 43 per cent. The danger, and more alarmingly, if we take the mortality rate with respect to children out of the statistics, we are hitting more than 65 per cent. In governance, we deduce solutions for challenges in the system.

Mr Speaker, if you ask me as I stand here, the main challenge in our health sector at the moment is the NCDs. Nothing can be more serious than the NCDs, I am telling you the fact. It is not infections, pandemic or an outbreak, it is NCDs, and that is why there is a need for us to think out of the box, to find innovative ways and to find solutions to this particular matter. Once a person has this condition, as the Majority Leader clearly stated, he can only manage, he cannot cure. If a person does not have the resources, he will go into a grave quickly. Even if a person has the resources, Mr Speaker, he ends up being very poor.

So, it is important for all of us to begin to share the burden so that we can spread the burden to allow people

who live with this condition to get, at least, some relief.

Mr Speaker, I have heard about the issues of capping. As my Hon Friend said, we have all spoken against the capping of the National Health Insurance on the floor of the House. But the difference between allocating 20 per cent of the National Health Insurance to Ghana Medical Trust Fund and what used to be the case is that now we are investing that same money in the health sector. Mr Speaker, if we decide —

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I thought the Minister would allow sleeping dogs to lie and for us to proceed on a certain peaceful path.

8.52 p.m.

But to now start another argument trying to justify that which cannot be justified—

Mr Speaker, the Bill that he is holding has its own ambiguities with the existing law. If we look at the Bill, what he wants to introduce, and what we already have, there are embedded ambiguities. Maybe he has not read it—*[Interruption]*—Yes, it is possible. If he has, he would not make the argument he is making. Because those gaps have been identified and it is his duty to acknowledge and concede to them rather than to argue that there are no gaps. We do not just get up— I am not on my feet just to argue. But he should look at his Bill.

He should look at the NHIS law and tell me whether there are no ambiguities, whether there are no gaps. That is why I do not want the Hon Minister to start on that path. Because, whatever he is trying to introduce—He and I know that this Bill is introducing duplication.

Mr Speaker, we have decided to move on, so let us move on. But he should not attempt to re-argue. We have a health insurance law, which is already operating. Now he says he is taking 20 per cent? We have already agreed, so he should just move on and stop this path that he is going. It is not going to help him. The path he is choosing will not help him so he should just conclude and let us make progress.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, just conclude for us.

Minister for Health (Mr Kwabena Mintah Akandoh) (MP): Mr Speaker, let us be fair. With the greatest of respect, I am struggling to see the point the Minority Leader has made on the Floor. He has just mentioned gaps without saying anything.

Mr Speaker, I have been wholly involved in this particular Bill. This is my Bill. I took it to Cabinet and I took the Committee through, clause by clause. And I defended more than 70 per cent of the clauses yesterday with the Committee. He should ask his Ranking Member. To say I do not understand because I have not read it

is an insult. With the greatest deal of respect to him, respect is reciprocal, Mr Speaker. We cannot take anybody for granted on this Floor.

Mr Speaker, we must begin to pay particular attention to certain provisions in the Bill. Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader drew our attention to clause 22. And at that same place, if we go to clause 22 (2), with your permission I read:

“A person who donates to the Fund is, in accordance with section 100 of the Income Tax Act 2015, entitled to claim a deduction that is equal to the donation made to the Fund”.

If this is not brilliant, what is it? And we are not looking at such provisions. We are looking at one angle.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I thank you for the opportunity. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, my duty is to put the Question after this lengthy debate.

Question put and—

First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu): Thank you, Mr Speaker—*[Uproar]*—Mr Speaker, you gave an indication that you want to put the Question and I urge you not to.

Mr Speaker, you cannot put the Question now. Because we, in the Chamber at the moment, are 58.

[Some Hon Members: Ei!] Mr Speaker, if you read Article 104 of the 1992 Constitution, it says decisions in Parliament shall be determined by more than half of the number. The highest court of the land, the Supreme Court, in the case of *Abdulai v the Attorney-General*, held that matters to be determined in Parliament must be determined by more than half of the numbers.

Mr Speaker, we do not have 138 Members in this Chamber. I urge you not to put the Question. Mr Speaker, the Constitution — I will read Article 104 (1):

“Except as otherwise provided in this Constitution, matters in Parliament shall be determined by the votes of majority of members present and voting, with at least half of the members of Parliament present.”

Mr Speaker, we are not up to 138 in this Chamber. We cannot take that decision. Mr Speaker, I urge you to defer the Question. When we have 138 Members in the Chamber, then we can take that decision.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib, you cannot ask me not to put the Question. [*Hear! Hear!*] Hold on. If you want to invoke the Constitutional provision, then you do so. Then I will see that you have invoked the Constitution. But you cannot ask me not to put the Question.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, with respect, I am guided. I am drawing your attention and invoking Article 104 of the Constitution, drawing your attention to the absence of decision-making quorum as made clear in the Constitution.

Mr Speaker, with your permission, I just read Article 104 (1):

“Except as otherwise provided in this Constitution, matters in Parliament shall be determined by the vote of majority of members present and voting, with at least half of all the members of Parliament present.”

Mr Speaker, half of the Members of Parliament is 138 and we are not 138. I will make the application that we do not have a decision-making quorum. The Constitution is clear and there is a decision from the Supreme Court in *Abdulai v the Attorney-General*, where the Supreme Court, the highest court of the land, has made it clear that, in decisions that need to be determined by Parliament, we should have more than half of our Members present and we do not have that present.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, indeed, you hit the nail right on the head when you said that he cannot

stop you from putting the Question, because the Rules do not permit him to do that. He can only pounce after the Question has been put and a decision made. Then he can challenge the number of Members present on the Floor and taking part in the decision.

Mr Speaker, in any case, the constitutional provision that the Hon Habib has invoked, procedure is provided in our Rules as to how he should proceed with it. If you read Order 64 (1), it is to the effect that:

“(1) A quorum of Parliament apart from the person presiding is one-third of all the Members of Parliament.

(2) Where the person presiding is a Deputy Speaker or a Member, that person shall be counted as part of the quorum.

(3) A Member may draw the attention of the person presiding at any time during a sitting, that Members present in the House, constitute less than one-third of the number of all the Members of Parliament.

(4) The person presiding shall

(a) direct the Clerks-at-the-Table to cause the bell to be rang;

(b) continue the business of the House for a period of ten minutes;

(c) direct the Clerks-at-the-Table to conduct a headcount of members present; and

(d) if there is a still no quorum, suspend the sitting of the House for a period of not more than one hour.

(5) If on resumption of the Sitting there is still no quorum upon the conduct of a headcount, the House shall stand adjourned till the next sitting day without Question being put.”

Mr Speaker, if he gets up to recite the Constitution—*[Interruption]*—Yes without the Question being put.

Mr Speaker, to merely get up and recite the Constitution without having recourse to the procedure under Order 64, is neither here nor there.

9.02 p.m.

So, we will proceed with Business. The procedure provided for the Chair to invoke 64 is clearly outlined: the bell would have to be rung; if that is what he is calling for, that is what is invoked, but he cannot say that you cannot put the Question. The Business of the House would have to make progress.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, even though the Majority Chief Whip attempted explaining this,

in Parliament and Business of the House, we have two quorums: we have a quorum to commence Business and we have a quorum to take a decision. If you read our Orders very well in Order 64, it has reference to Article 102 of the Constitution. Article 102 of the Constitution talks about quorum to commence Business or do Business. But I quoted Article 104, which is a decision-making quorum. So, in Parliament, we have two quorums: a quorum to commence Business or do Business and a quorum to take a decision.

Mr Speaker, I am referring you to Article 104, not 102. The Order 64 he referred to is in reference to Article 102 and, Mr Speaker, I read Article 102,

“A quorum of Parliament, apart from the person presiding, shall be one third of all Members of Parliament”.

That is not what I am referring to; I am referring to Article 104, not 102.

Mr Speaker, even what he has referred to, that is not what I am referring to. I am talking about decision-making quorum. There are two quorums and I am not referring to a quorum that is in Article 102 of the Constitution, but the quorum in Article 104 of the Constitution for us to take decision and we do not have the number to take that decision.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, before my Leader comes in, I referenced Order 64(5) and, sometimes, we listen to Alhaji Habib Iddrisu, so he should also take his time and listen. The Order is to this effect that if, on resumption of the Sitting, there is still no quorum upon the conduct of a headcount—*[Interruption]*—Please, can you stop this? You are challenging the Speaker not to put a Question, which is a procedural matter—*[Interruption]*—So, what did you do?

So, Mr Speaker, Order 64(5) is to the effect—And he should listen again:

“If on the resumption of the Sitting, there is still no quorum upon the conduct of a headcount, the House shall stand adjourned till the next day without a Question being put”.

Mr Speaker was about to put a Question, then he rose and sought to arrest that which was clearly out of Order. He has been put right and we have invoked the procedural law for him to follow and now he says that he is not invoking Article 102, but rather Article 104. Is Article 104 a procedural law? This is the procedural law and what we are doing is governed by procedure.

Mr Speaker, he can invoke Article 104 in the Supreme Court. He will say that a decision has been taken by Parliament, which is in breach of Article 104. So, he is seeking

interpretation, but he cannot say that, willy-nilly, he has invoked Article 104, so everything should come to a close. Yes, so, he must marry the substantive law to the procedural law. That is how we do it, Hon Habib Iddrisu. Take your time and be calm.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I need to make my stand very clear. Mr Speaker, I have raised a decision-making quorum under Article 104 of the Constitution. That is what I have raised. I have not raised Article 102 or Order 64. I have not at all. I did not raise Order 64 or Article 102 of the Constitution. I raised Article 104 of the Constitution, which is a decision-making quorum.

Mr Speaker, we just finished a debate and you are about to put a Question, which is going to be a decision we are going to make and that is why I drew your attention to the fact that we do not have 138 Members of Parliament present and I am surprised: when it comes to constitutional law, I respect the Majority Chief Whip, but he will be the one here quoting *Abdulai v the Attorney-General* and now it is missing. What did *Abdulai v the Attorney-General* say?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members—

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: So, Mr Speaker, we do not have that decision and you cannot put a Question, Mr Speaker, let us defer the Question.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members—

Yes, Majority Leader, if you want to—

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I am going to say two things. One is to try and explain the law, so that we are all guided, but on the substantive Question of the Business for today, we will confer and take a decision. But let me just indicate that the law is stated clearly in Article 104(1) that:

“Except as otherwise provided in this Constitution, matters in Parliament shall be determined by the votes of the majority of members present and voting, with at least half of all the members of Parliament present”.

I think that is the decision-making quorum that Hon Habib Iddrisu is talking about. Now, Hon Habib is trying to raise an objection on the basis of the absence of a decision-making quorum, but he will have to find a procedure in the Standing Orders to stand on and that is where we are challenged. Now, there are two provisions that deal with quorum and voting in the Standing Orders. We have at Order 139(1):

“Voting in Parliament (cf. article 104 of the Constitution)

139. (1) Subject to the Constitution and these Orders, a Question shall be determined by the votes of the

majority of Members present and voting with at least half of the members of Parliament present”.

So, that just repeats 104. Now, he cannot stand up and say we do not have the numbers, so do not put the Question. He cannot do that. He will have to wait for Order 151 to kick in and Order 151 deals with voting by Members and it says that:

“When the Question has been put by the Speaker at the conclusion of a debate, the vote shall be taken by a voice indicating

- (a) ‘Aye’;
- (b) ‘no’; or
- (c) ‘Abstention’”.

Now, when Members vote, he can then challenge the decision of Mr Speaker. When he challenges the decision of Mr Speaker and call for a head count, the head count will expose the absence of quorum. But he cannot just get up and say do not put the Question. No, he cannot do that. Mr Speaker can put the Question and declare in favour of the “Yes or the Noes”; then he challenges the decision of Mr Speaker and call for a headcount. When they count the heads, they will see that there is no quorum. Then, he now raises the constitutional issues that the Constitution even expects that we have half of us and we do not have half of us. So, the decision fails.

Mr Speaker, today, we had a very big conference in Tamale which took

about 57 Members of Parliament to Tamale for the conference on Northern Development by the Northern Caucus, so, as a result, we have some challenges with our numbers. So, I was pleading with our Colleagues and, indeed, it was attended by me and then my Colleague, the Minority Leader.

I know for sure that many of our Colleagues flew back with us, but, out of exhaustion, they have not come to the House. We, as Leaders, feel responsible to come and see what is happening here. So even Hon Habib Iddrisu was there.

9.12 p.m.

We do not have the numbers, so I was pleading with my Colleague that, at least, we should take the vote on the Report so that we can adopt the Report and defer the Consideration of the Bill to tomorrow. But if my Colleagues have a strong objection to us taking the vote, I have no problem with us deferring and taking the Question tomorrow.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
Thank you very much, Hon Majority Leader.

I was going to say the same thing. Hon Members, the Standing Orders are there—Hon Leader, personally, my view is that once the Hon Member invokes the Constitution, it is clear and until he decides to put it aside, I have no option than to adjourn the House to tomorrow.

Hon Members, the Constitution is clear, so once he did not use the Standing Orders, whereby, probably, we would go through the procedure, we do not have the numbers. If he abandons his application, we will move on. Other than that, please, indulge me to end the proceedings. We started at exactly 2.00 p.m. and I am tired, so we can adjourn till tomorrow.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin —*rose*—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, I think that is exactly the same thing you are going to say.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, you must hear me. The Majority Leader has spoken. You have not asked to know my mind's construction.

Mr Speaker, all I want to say for the record is that I associate myself with the views expressed by the Leader of the House, except that on the point where he concludes by saying that since our Side strongly objects, that part, Mr Speaker, I do not think it is most appropriate for our records. It is not the case. I believe that the issues that came up when we all got in, we built consensus on them and at least, we have come far.

I also think that these proceedings being carried live, the general public is aware of our numbers in the Chamber. So, it is not about the Minority saying no. It is that we do not have the numbers to take a decision. And for me, that is what the

records should reflect. I said this earlier, last week, even when we did the University Development Studies Bill and later proceeded to do the Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, we heard what the public sought to say and all.

So, Mr Speaker, I think that the position by the Majority Leader that we place this on ice and deal with it tomorrow is fair. So that we would have fortified ourselves with the constitutional provision, save that it is not the Minority taking objection to the Motion. He raised a constitutional issue, with respect, and if he raised a constitutional—*[Interruption]*—Yes, but he is not shying away. That is what the Constitution says.

I am sure if he is aware of the records of this House, he will know. He can play the video of Hon Akandoh, then the Ranking Member on the Committee on Health. I am not sure he has seen all his videos. The Ranking Member, the man, now the Minister for Health, when he was here—*[Interruption]*—It is not payback time, but what I am saying is that I am not sure you have watched his videos.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well, so Leader?

My Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Rules of this House are known to us; the practitioners and the Rules have not changed since the 1992 Constitution was enacted and this Parliament was inaugurated, from the First Parliament through to the Ninth Parliament.

Mr Speaker, quorum is based on the mood of the House—*[Laughter]*—It is not the numbers in the Chamber. The reason I say so is that we have passed legislation with 20 people in this Chamber or with five people in this Chamber. We have done that. I do not want a situation where tomorrow, when people are watching television and they see that we are only about 50 or 60 and we pass a legislation, then they will say that we violated the Constitution. No. Quorum is that when we come to this House, we register that we have attended and we are around.

As we speak, you can see that because we are raising issues of quorum, people have started walking in. The Deputy Leader has just walked in and others have walked in. People are sitting in their offices. If we raise an issue of quorum, then the Speaker will cause the Clerks-at-the-Table to ring a bell, so that all those who are around the building but are not in the Chamber will now come in and then we will count and have the numbers. If we are determined to pass this Bill, we may even say we are asking for a short suspension of Sitting.

Mr Speaker will suspend Sitting and we will call everybody and give them 15 minutes. Wherever they are in Accra, they will get into this Chamber and we will pass the Bill. So, Mr Speaker, it is just because the two of us have conferred and he has requested that I consider deferring this matter to tomorrow. I do not want it to be that there is a violation of the Constitution or that we in the Majority

are incapable of having the Motion taken today and that is why the Motion is not being taken.

Sometimes, we do not show might, force or power. We do not abuse. It is just a compromise. Otherwise, if I want this thing to happen, I will just say, Mr Speaker, suspend Sitting for 30 minutes. Then everybody will be in the Chamber in the next 20 minutes and we will pass it.

So, I think that we need the public to understand this. That we are not violating our Rules or the Constitution. We are tired; it is 9.00 p.m. and we are listening to each other. The Minority Leader and I travelled to Tamale, we addressed crowds, managed to fly back and we are in this Chamber. We are human beings; we get tired.

So, when there is an appeal based on exhaustion—He left the day before yesterday, went and effectively organised a very successful Northern Peoples' Conference, then he managed to get back this afternoon to come and cause all the confusion that he is causing in this Chamber—*[Laughter]*—Hajia Laadi was with us. In fact, because of this Bill, she had to even buy her own ticket and leave earlier to get in, so that she would be able to participate because she is on that Committee.

So, Mr Speaker, we are really exhausted, so we are in your hands and we will allow you to adjourn.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader, though he was in his diplomatic best, now issues some subtle threats. He says that if he is dared, he would call for suspension and within 30 minutes, he will get his numbers here. Mr Speaker, the mood on his own Side is very bad.

I want to challenge the Majority Leader that in 30 minutes' his people will not come. I want to challenge him—*[Interruption]*—Yes, 30 minutes. Mr Speaker, suspend for 30 minutes and let us see whether his people will come. His people are not in a good mood.

9.22 p.m.

Mr Speaker, the mood; his people are not in a good mood, so I dare him. Mr Speaker, let us grant him his wish. Let us suspend for 30 minutes and see the might of the Majority Chief Whip.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, enough is enough.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the last time he dared me, I kept this Side till 3 a.m. in the morning and we passed the Gold Board Bill. Mr Speaker, he should not dare me *fa*. Hausa people would say, “do not dare me *fa*”—*[Laughter]*—If he dares me *fa*, I will do it.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Leader, I think you said it all. The mood of the House for both Sides is very important, at least, for the two weeks ahead of us. Majority Leader, the mood of the House must always be positive, so that it does not urge anybody to raise constitutional provisions. This is because if I am the one sitting here and the constitutional provision is made, I will have no option. I believe the mood of the House will always be good for all of us to stay as long as we want to do Business.

On that note, we will adjourn the House. We have done enough from 2:00 p.m. to almost 9:30 p.m. What time are we coming tomorrow?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, 10 a.m., humbly.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leadership? Wonderful.

Hon Members, I would like to thank you once again. We have been here since 2:00 p.m. and it is now almost 9.30 p.m. We have done a lot and we will adjourn the House till tomorrow at 10 a.m. in the forenoon. The House stands adjourned.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was adjourned at 9:24 p.m. till Tuesday, 22nd July, 2025, at 10:00 a.m.

Editor's Note

This *Official Report* was corrected by the House on 30th July, 2025, as follows:

- (a) Column 74, the last paragraph,
last but one line, “s’ was added
to “award”.
- (b) Column 90, paragraph 4, line 2,
“the” was insert before “CAF”.